SUMS OF TWO SQUARES WITH FEW PRIME FACTORS, II: THE MEAN SQUARE OF THE CUSPIDAL ERROR OF $\theta^2(mz)\theta^2(m'z)$, ALMOST ALL N, AND THE SIZE OF THE PETERSSON NORM

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ABSTRACT. Let m, m' be coprime odd integers, $\Theta_{m,m'}(z) = \theta^2(mz)\theta^2(m'z)$, $G_{m,m'}$ its cuspidal part and $L = 4mm'$, so that $a_G(N) = T(m, m'; N) - M(m, m'; N)$ is the error term in the number of representations of N by $m(x^2+y^2)+m'(z^2+w^2)$. Part I proved $\|G_{m,m'}\|^2 \ll_\varepsilon (mm')^\varepsilon$ for the Petersson norm and deduced the level of distribution $1/2$ for the weighted sequence $r(n)r(N-n)$ and the bounds $\Omega(n(N-n)) \le 8$, $\max(\Omega(n), \Omega(N-n)) \le 5$ for every large $N \equiv 2 \pmod 4$. Here we prove a mean-square bound $\sum_{N\le Y} |a_G(N)|^2 \le 4\pi e^2 Y(1 + 54Y/L)\|G\|^2$ for every $G \in S_2(\Gamma_0(L))$ by a covering argument; for $G_{m,m'}$ it says that the root mean square of $(T - M)/\sqrt{N}$ is $\ll (mm')^{-1/2+\varepsilon}$, and it gives the level of distribution $1 - \varepsilon$ for the weighted sequence for all but $O(X^{1-\delta})$ integers $N \le X$, and for those N the bounds 5 and 4 (a result which, as an arithmetic statement about almost all N, is superseded by the circle method, which gives $N = p + q$ with $p \equiv q \equiv 1 \pmod 4$). We reformulate the uniform bound of Part I in terms of Poincaré series, state the individual bound $|T - M| \ll N^{1/2+\varepsilon}(mm')^{-1/2+\varepsilon}$ suggested by the data, and show that any power saving in mm' for individual N raises the level of distribution for every N beyond $1/2$. Finally we prove the lower bound $\|G_{m,m'}\|^2 \ge \frac{1}{\pi}\big((\log m)^2 + (\log m')^2\big) - O\big(\log(2mm')(\log\log 3mm')^C\big)$ by integrating $|G|^2$ over the parts of the fundamental domain above the four Atkin–Lehner cusps at which $G_{m,m'}$ is transformed into $G_{1,mm'}$, whose first mm' coefficients are $r(n) - M(1, mm'; n)$; so the norm is of the order $(\log mm')^2$ up to the factor $(mm')^\varepsilon$, and the exponent ε cannot be replaced by 0. Numerically, the regions above all the cusps account for 93–98% of the norm, which is a quadratic form in $\log m$, $\log m'$ plus contributions of the other divisors of mm' rather than a constant times $(\log mm')^2$; there is an exact check at the level 20, and the supremum of $|T - M|/\sqrt{N}$ over N exceeds the root mean square by a bounded factor at every level computed. Finally, replacing the vector sieve of Part I by the two-dimensional sieve of Diamond, Halberstam and Richert, whose functions F_2, f_2 we compute, gives $\Omega(n(N-n)) \le 7$ with $\max(\Omega(n), \Omega(N-n)) \le 5$ for every large $N \equiv 2 \pmod 4$ from the same level $1/2$, subject to two numerical inequalities for F_2, f_2 that we verify in floating point.

1. RESULTS

We keep the notation of [5], referred to as Part I. Thus $r(n)$ is the number of representations of n as a sum of two squares, m, m' are coprime odd positive integers,

$$T(m, m'; N) = \sum_{ma+m'b=N} r(a)r(b), \qquad L = 4mm',$$

$$\Theta_{m,m'}(z) = \theta^2(mz)\theta^2(m'z) = \sum_{N\ge 0} T(m, m'; N)e(Nz) \in M_2(\Gamma_0(L)),$$

$\Theta_{m,m'} = E + G$ is the decomposition into the Eisenstein part, whose coefficients are the Siegel main terms $M(m, m'; N)$, and the cuspidal part $G = G_{m,m'} \in S_2(\Gamma_0(L))$, so that

$$a_G(N) = T(m, m'; N) - M(m, m'; N) \qquad \text{for every } N \ge 1.$$

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The Petersson norm is $\|G\|^2 = \int_{\Gamma_0(L)\backslash\mathbb{H}} |G|^2 \,\mathrm{d}x\,\mathrm{d}y$. Lemma 2.1 of Part I, which is Waibel's theorem [11, Theorem 1] for the form $Q_{m,m'} = m(x^2+y^2) + m'(z^2+w^2)$, gives $\|G\| \ll (mm')^{1/4+\varepsilon}$, and the first two versions of Part I deduced from it, through a Hecke operator, the uniform bound $a_G(N) \ll d(N) N^{1/2} (mm')^{1/4+\varepsilon}$ for $(N, mm') = 1$, $v_2(N) \le 1$, the level of distribution 2/5 and the bounds 9 and 6, and conjectured (Conjecture 5.1 there) that the factor $(mm')^{1/4}$ can be removed. Version 3 of Part I, which this paper accompanies, proves that the norm itself is much smaller than Waibel's general bound, by computing the expansion of $\Theta_{m,m'}$ at every cusp of $\Gamma_0(L)$ with Waibel's method, and draws the consequences. We recall what we use.

Theorem 1.1 (Part I, Theorems 1.2 and 2.3)**.** *Let m, m' be coprime odd positive integers.*

(i) $\|G_{m,m'}\|^2 \ll_\varepsilon (mm')^\varepsilon$.

(ii) *For $N \ge 1$ with $(N, mm') = 1$ and $v_2(N) \le 1$,*

$$T(m, m'; N) = M(m, m'; N) + O_\varepsilon\big(d(N)\, N^{1/2} (mm')^\varepsilon\big);$$

for cube-free m, m' and every N with $v_2(N) \le 1$ the error term is $O_\varepsilon(d(N)^4 N^{1/2} (mm')^\varepsilon)$ (Part I, Corollary 2.7).

Part I deduces from (ii) that $r(n)r(N-n)$ has level of distribution 1/2 (Theorem 3.2 there) and, with sieve parameters certified in interval arithmetic, that for every sufficiently large $N \equiv 2 \pmod 4$

$$\#\big\{1 \le n < N :\ n = x^2+y^2,\ N-n = z^2+w^2,\ \Omega(n(N-n)) \le 8,\ \max(\Omega(n), \Omega(N-n)) \le 5\big\} \ge\ 0.23\, \mathfrak{S}_r(N)\, \frac{N}{(\log N)^2}, \qquad \mathfrak{S}_r(N) = \prod_{\substack{p \mid N \\ p > 2}} \frac{p-1}{p-2},$$

(Theorem 1.1 there; versions 1–2 had 9 and 6). The proof of (i) shows that the expansion of $\Theta_{m,m'}$ at every cusp is again a theta series of a form $A(x_1^2+x_2^2) + B(x_3^2+x_4^2)$ with $AB \asymp mm'$, whose coefficients are $O(n^\varepsilon)$ for $n \ll mm'$ because $A\alpha + B\beta = n$ has $O(1)$ solutions, and suggests $\|G_{m,m'}\|^2 \asymp (\log mm')^2$ (Part I, Remark 2.13); numerically, $\|G_{m,m'}\|^2 \approx 0.37\,(\log mm')^2$ (Section 5). Theorem 1.5 below proves the lower bound, and Section 6 decomposes the norm over the cusps.

The first theme of this paper is the average over N of the error term, which is of independent interest and gives a stronger level of distribution for almost all N.

Theorem 1.2 (Mean square)**.** *Let $L \ge 1$, $G \in S_2(\Gamma_0(L))$ and $Y \ge 1$. Then*

$$\sum_{n \le Y} |a_G(n)|^2 \ \le\ 4\pi e^2\, Y \Big(1 + \frac{54\, Y}{L}\Big) \|G\|^2. \tag{1}$$

In particular, for coprime odd m, m', $G = G_{m,m'}$ and $Y \ge mm'$, by Theorem 1.1(i),

$$\sum_{N \le Y} \big|T(m, m'; N) - M(m, m'; N)\big|^2 \ \ll_\varepsilon\ Y^2\, (mm')^{-1+\varepsilon}, \tag{2}$$

and hence, since $\sum_{Y/2 < N \le Y} |a_G(N)|^2/N \ \le\ (2/Y) \sum_{N \le Y} |a_G(N)|^2$, the root mean square of $(T-M)/\sqrt{N}$ over $Y/2 < N \le Y$ is $\ll (mm')^{-1/2+\varepsilon}$.

The proof of (1) is a classical covering argument and does not use the Petersson formula; the dependence on the level is exactly the factor Y/L, i.e. the volume of $\Gamma_0(L)\backslash\mathbb{H}$. The bound (2) is the exact order of magnitude: by the Rankin–Selberg method the mean square of $(T-M)/\sqrt{N}$ is asymptotic to $16\pi^2 \|G\|^2 / \operatorname{vol}(\Gamma_0(L)\backslash\mathbb{H})$, and Table 1 shows the data.

Averaging over N is natural for the arithmetic application, since the sieve of Part I is applied to one N at a time and an exceptional set of N can be tolerated. Let, as in Part I, $N \equiv 2 \pmod 4$, $\mathcal{A} = \{n \le N : \ (n,N)=1\}$, $w(n) = r(n)r(N-n)$, and for coprime square-free d, e with $(de, 2N) = 1$ let $R(d,e) = R(d,e;N)$ be the remainder in

$$\sum_{\substack{n\in\mathcal{A}\\ d\mid n,\ e\mid N-n}} w(n) = X_N\, h(d)h(e) + R(d,e;N)$$

(this is $S(d,e) = M(d,e) + R(d,e)$ of Part I, Section 3; we write X_N for the main term X there, to avoid a clash with the length X of the range of N below).

Theorem 1.3 (Level of distribution $1-\varepsilon$ for almost all N)**.** *Let $0 < \varepsilon < 1/20$, $X \ge X_0(\varepsilon)$ and $D = X^{1-3\varepsilon}$. Then*

$$\sum_{\substack{X/2<N\le X\\ N\equiv 2\ (4)}} \sum_{\substack{de\le D,\ (d,e)=1\\ (de,2N)=1}} \mu^2(de)\, d_3(de)\, |R(d,e;N)| \ \ll_\varepsilon \ X^{2-\varepsilon/2}.$$

Consequently, for all but $O_\varepsilon(X^{1-\varepsilon/4})$ integers $N \equiv 2 \pmod 4$ in $(X/2, X]$,

$$\sum_{\substack{de\le N^{1-3\varepsilon}\\ (d,e)=1,\ (de,2N)=1}} \mu^2(de)\, d_3(de)\, |R(d,e;N)| \ \le \ N^{1-\varepsilon/5}. \tag{3}$$

The sieve of Part I, Section 4, uses the level of distribution only through (3); running it at the level $\theta = 19/20$ gives the following.

Corollary 1.4. *For all but $O(X^{1-\delta})$ integers $N \equiv 2 \pmod 4$ in $(X/2, X]$, with an absolute $\delta > 0$,*

$$\#\big\{1 \le n < N : \ n = x^2+y^2,\ N-n = z^2+w^2,\ \Omega(n(N-n)) \le 5,\ \max(\Omega(n), \Omega(N-n)) \le 4\big\} \ge \ 0.34\, \mathfrak{S}_r(N)\, \frac{N}{(\log N)^2},$$

the integers counted being coprime to N and products of distinct primes $\equiv 1 \pmod 4$ exceeding $N^{2/25}$.

The certified sieve parameters are $\alpha = 2/25$, $\lambda = 1/3$, $\beta_1 = 69/100$ (Section 3). The pairs $(5,4)$ for almost all N and $(8,5)$ for every N should be compared with $(9,6)$ for every N, which is what Waibel's bound alone gives (Part I, Remark 4.5). A floating-point scan (Figure 2) shows that the best attainable value of $1/\lambda + 1/\beta_1$ drops below 4 only for $\theta > 0.88$; at $\theta = 19/20$ the scan gives 3.83 (at $\alpha = 0.10$, $\beta_1 = 0.47$, $\lambda = 0.59$, with $1/\lambda + 2/\beta_1 = 5.96$), i.e. the pair $(5,3)$, which we have not certified, for the reason explained next.

Corollary 1.4 must also be compared with what the circle method gives for almost all N. By the method of Montgomery and Vaughan [9], carried out with the characters modulo 4 (see [4] for Goldbach's problem with primes in prescribed residue classes), all but $O(X^{1-\delta})$ integers $N \equiv 2 \pmod 4$ up to X are sums $p+q$ of two primes $p \equiv q \equiv 1 \pmod 4$, with $\gg \mathfrak{S}_r(N)N/(\log N)^2$ representations; such primes are sums of two squares, so for almost all N the pair $(1,1)$ holds with the count of Corollary 1.4. As an arithmetic statement about almost all N, Corollary 1.4 is therefore far from new. What is new is Theorem 1.3, a level of distribution $1-\varepsilon$ for the weighted sequence $r(n)r(N-n)$, together with the observation that the sieve of Part I extracts $(5,4)$ from it with no further input; the sieve route adds something only for *every* N, where the circle method gives nothing (Goldbach's problem) and where Part I gives $(8,5)$. Section 4 formulates

the individual bound that would raise the level to $1-\varepsilon$ for every N and with it give $(5,4)$ for every N (Proposition 4.2).

The third theme is the size of the norm itself. Theorem 1.1(i) is an upper bound. The proof in Part I shows that the expansion of $\Theta_{m,m'}$ at every cusp of $\Gamma_0(L)$ is a theta series of a form $A(x_1^2+x_2^2)+B(x_3^2+x_4^2)$ with $AB \asymp mm'$; at the four cusps which are the images of ∞ under the Atkin–Lehner involutions W_m, W_{4m}, $W_{m'}$, $W_{4m'}$ this form is $x_1^2+x_2^2+mm'(x_3^2+x_4^2)$, whose first mm' representation numbers are the $r(n)$ themselves, and there $G_{m,m'}$ is transformed, exactly, into $G_{1,mm'}$. Integrating $|G|^2$ over the parts of the fundamental domain above these four cusps gives a lower bound.

Theorem 1.5 (Lower bound for the norm)**.** *Let m, m' be coprime odd positive integers with $mm' > 1$, and let $a(n) = a_{G_{1,mm'}}(n) = T(1,mm';n) - M(1,mm';n)$, so that $a(n) = r(n) - M(1,mm';n)$ for $1 \le n < mm'$.*

(i) $$\|G_{m,m'}\|^2 \;\ge\; \frac{1}{4\pi} \sum_{Q\in\{m,\,4m,\,m',\,4m'\}} \sum_{n\ge 1} \frac{|a(n)|^2}{n}\, e^{-4\pi n/Q}.$$

(ii) *There is an absolute constant C such that*

$$\begin{aligned}\|G_{m,m'}\|^2 \;&\ge\; \frac{1}{\pi}\big((\log m)^2+(\log m')^2\big) - C\log(2mm')\,(\log\log 3mm')^C\\ &\ge\; \frac{1}{2\pi}(\log mm')^2 - C\log(2mm')\,(\log\log 3mm')^C.\end{aligned}$$

Together with Theorem 1.1(i), $(\log mm')^2 \ll \|G_{m,m'}\|^2 \ll_\varepsilon (mm')^\varepsilon$ for $mm' \ge C'$, and the exponent ε cannot be replaced by 0. The inequality (i) is nearly an equality when $m=1$: the four regions then cover the fraction $5/(2\pi) = 0.80$ of the area of $\Gamma_0(L)\backslash\mathbb{H}$, and numerically they carry 98% of the norm (Table 3). The proof is in Section 6, which also computes, for square-free m, m', the contribution of every cusp and explains the empirical law of Section 5: the norm is not $c(\log mm')^2$ but $\frac{1}{\pi}((\log m)^2+(\log m')^2) + \frac{5}{\pi^2}\log m\log m' + \cdots$, a sum over the divisors of mm'.

The fourth theme is the sieve itself. Part I sifts n and $N-n$ by the vector sieve of Brüdern and Fouvry, two linear sieves combined; but $n(N-n)$ is a sieve problem of dimension 2 (Remark 3.3), and the two-dimensional sieve of Diamond, Halberstam and Richert [7, 6], with Richert's weights, has the smaller sieving limit $\beta_2 = 4.2665$. Section 7 computes its sieve functions F_2, f_2 (we determine the constants $\alpha_2 = 5.3577$, $\beta_2 = 4.2665$ of [7] independently) and obtains, from the same level of distribution $1/2$ of Part I,

$$\Omega(n(N-n)) \le 7, \qquad \max(\Omega(n), \Omega(N-n)) \le 5$$

for $\ge 0.25\,\mathfrak{S}_r(N)N/(\log N)^2$ integers n, for every large $N \equiv 2 \pmod 4$ (Theorem 7.1): $(7,5)$ in place of $(8,5)$. The sieve functions enter through two explicit numerical inequalities ((17)), which hold with a margin in our computation but which, unlike the linear sieve functions of Part I, we have not certified in interval arithmetic.

Section 4 restates the uniform bound of Theorem 1.1(ii) in terms of Poincaré series and formulates the individual bound, Section 5 contains the numerical evidence: the data of Part I, an exact check of the whole numerical chain at the level 20, the empirical law $\|G_{m,m'}\|^2 \approx 0.37(\log mm')^2$, which corrects a remark in the first two versions of Part I, and the supremum of $|T-M|/\sqrt{N}$ over N; Section 6 proves Theorem 1.5 and decomposes the norm over the cusps; Section 7 contains the two-dimensional sieve; and Section 8 describes the sum over the moduli that a level beyond $1/2$ for every N would require, in the form of a dispersion problem, with numerical evidence that its terms cancel like random signs.

2. Proof of Theorem 1.2

Let $G(z)=\sum_{n\ge1}a(n)e(nz)\in S_2(\Gamma_0(L))$ and put $F(z)=y^2|G(z)|^2$, $z=x+iy$. Since $G(\gamma z)=(cz+d)^2G(z)$ and $\operatorname{Im}(\gamma z)=y/|cz+d|^2$ for $\gamma=\left(\begin{smallmatrix}a&b\\c&d\end{smallmatrix}\right)\in\Gamma_0(L)$, the function F is $\Gamma_0(L)$-invariant, and with the invariant measure $\mathrm{d}\mu=y^{-2}\mathrm{d}x\,\mathrm{d}y$ we have $\|G\|^2=\int_{\mathcal F}F\,\mathrm{d}\mu$ for any fundamental domain $\mathcal F$ of $\Gamma_0(L)$.

Let $y_0=1/(4\pi Y)$ and $R=\{x+iy:\ 0\le x<1,\ y_0\le y\le 2y_0\}$ (half-open in x, so that each orbit of the translations $z\mapsto z+b$ meets R at most once). By Parseval, $\int_0^1|G(x+iy)|^2\,\mathrm{d}x=\sum_n|a(n)|^2e^{-4\pi ny}$, hence

$$\int_R|G|^2\,\mathrm{d}x\,\mathrm{d}y=\sum_n|a(n)|^2\int_{y_0}^{2y_0}e^{-4\pi ny}\,\mathrm{d}y\ \ge\ \frac{e^{-2}}{4\pi Y}\sum_{n\le Y}|a(n)|^2,$$

because $4\pi ny\le 8\pi Yy_0=2$ for $n\le Y$, $y\le 2y_0$. On the other hand $\int_R|G|^2\,\mathrm{d}x\,\mathrm{d}y=\int_R F\,\mathrm{d}\mu$, and

$$\int_R F\,\mathrm{d}\mu=\sum_{\gamma\in\Gamma_0(L)/\{\pm1\}}\int_{R\cap\gamma\mathcal F}F\,\mathrm{d}\mu=\int_{\mathcal F}F(w)\,\#\{\gamma:\ \gamma w\in R\}\,\mathrm{d}\mu(w)\ \le\ \mu_R\,\|G\|^2,$$

where $\mu_R=\sup_{z\in R}\#\{\gamma\in\Gamma_0(L)/\{\pm1\}:\ \gamma z\in R\}$ (if $\#\{\gamma:\gamma w\in R\}\ne0$ for some $w\in\mathcal F$, pick γ_0 with $z=\gamma_0 w\in R$; then $\gamma\mapsto\gamma\gamma_0^{-1}$ is a bijection from $\{\gamma:\gamma w\in R\}$ onto $\{\gamma:\gamma z\in R\}$, so the count at w is at most μ_R). It remains to bound μ_R. Fix $z=x+iy\in R$ and let $\gamma=\left(\begin{smallmatrix}a&b\\c&d\end{smallmatrix}\right)\in\Gamma_0(L)$ with $\gamma z\in R$.

- If $c=0$, then $\gamma=\pm\left(\begin{smallmatrix}1&b\\0&1\end{smallmatrix}\right)$ and $\gamma z=z+b$, so $x+b\in[0,1)$ forces $b=0$: one element.
- If $c\ne0$, we may take $c>0$, since γ and $-\gamma$ are the same element of $\Gamma_0(L)/\{\pm1\}$. Then $L\mid c$, and $\operatorname{Im}(\gamma z)=y/|cz+d|^2\in[y_0,2y_0]$ together with $y\in[y_0,2y_0]$ gives $|cz+d|^2\in[1/2,2]$. Since $|cz+d|^2=(cx+d)^2+c^2y^2$, this forces $c^2y^2\le2$, hence $c\le\sqrt2/y_0=4\sqrt2\,\pi Y$, and $|cx+d|\le\sqrt2$. The number of positive multiples c of L with $c\le4\sqrt2\pi Y$ is $\lfloor4\sqrt2\pi Y/L\rfloor\le4\sqrt2\pi\,Y/L$; for each c there are at most 3 integers d with $|cx+d|\le\sqrt2$; and for each pair (c,d) the elements of $\Gamma_0(L)$ with bottom row (c,d) are $\left(\begin{smallmatrix}1&k\\0&1\end{smallmatrix}\right)\gamma_0$, $k\in\mathbb Z$, whose images γ_0z+k have real part in $[0,1)$ for exactly one k. This gives at most $4\sqrt2\pi\cdot3\,Y/L=12\sqrt2\pi\,Y/L<54\,Y/L$ elements.

Hence $\mu_R\le1+54Y/L$, and

$$\sum_{n\le Y}|a(n)|^2\le4\pi e^2Y\int_R F\,\mathrm{d}\mu\le4\pi e^2\,Y\Big(1+\frac{54Y}{L}\Big)\|G\|^2,$$

which is (1). For $G=G_{m,m'}$, $L=4mm'$ and $Y\ge mm'$ the bracket is $\le1+54Y/(4mm')\le15Y/(mm')$, and Theorem 1.1(i) gives (2). □

Remark 2.1. The argument is the classical one for bounding $\sum_{n\le Y}|a(n)|^2$ by the norm (compare [10, Chapter 5]); its only input is the invariance of $y^2|G|^2$. The strip $y_0\le y\le2y_0$ with $y_0=1/(4\pi Y)$ is chosen so that the exponential factor in Parseval's identity stays at e^{-2} for all $n\le Y$. For $Y\ge L$ the factor Y^2/L in (1) is of the correct order of magnitude: by the Rankin–Selberg method, $\sum_{n\le Y}|a(n)|^2/n\sim16\pi^2\|G\|^2Y/\operatorname{vol}(\Gamma_0(L)\backslash\mathbb H)$ with $\operatorname{vol}=\frac{\pi}{3}L\prod_{p\mid L}(1+1/p)$ (measure $\mathrm{d}\mu$), so that $\sum_{n\le Y}|a(n)|^2\sim8\pi^2\|G\|^2Y^2/\operatorname{vol}$ for fixed G as $Y\to\infty$. Theorem 1.2 makes this uniform in the level, at the cost of the constant.

3. Proof of Theorem 1.3 and Corollary 1.4

3.1. **The remainder on average.** We follow the proof of Theorem 3.2 of Part I, replacing the uniform bound for $|T-M|$ by Theorem 1.2 after an application of Cauchy–Schwarz over N.

Recall from Part I, (16), that for $N \equiv 2 \pmod 4$ and coprime square-free d, e with $(de, 2N) = 1$,

$$(4)\quad R(d,e;N) = \sum_{t \mid N^\flat} \mu(t) \sum_{m \mid d^2} \sum_{m' \mid e^2} c_d(m) c_e(m') \sum_{\substack{t_1 \mid t^2 \\ t \mid t_1}} c_t(t_1) \big(a_G(N) - a_G(N/2)\big), \qquad G = G_{t_1 m, m'},$$

where $N^\flat$ is the product of the odd primes dividing N, $m = ds$, $m' = es'$ with $s \mid d$, $s' \mid e$, and likewise $t_1 = tu$ with $u \mid t$ (the coefficients $c_d(m)$, $c_t(t_1)$ of Part I, (15), vanish unless $m = ds$ with $s \mid d$, resp. $t_1 = tu$ with $u \mid t$; in particular $t \mid t_1$); the parameters $t_1 m, m'$ of the form $Q_{t_1 m, m'}$ are coprime, odd and cube-free, $\tilde{m}\tilde{m}' := t_1 m m' = t_1 s s' \cdot de$, and the coefficients c satisfy $|c_d(m) c_e(m') c_t(t_1)| \le 3^{\omega(d)+\omega(e)+\omega(t)}$. (For the reader's convenience: c_d is the multiplicative coefficient of Part I, (15), with $c_p(p) = 2$, $c_p(p^2) = -1$ for a split prime p and $c_q(q) = 0$, $c_q(q^2) = 1$ for an inert prime q; it encodes the identities $r(n) = 2r(n/p) - r(n/p^2)$ and $r(n) = r(n/q^2)$, which turn the condition $d \mid n$ into a combination of theta series $\theta^2(mz)$. The sum over t is the Möbius inversion of the condition $(n, N) = 1$, and $a_G(N) - a_G(N/2)$ selects the odd n.) Let $\eta = \varepsilon/10$. For $N \le X$ with $X \ge X_0(\varepsilon)$ we have, as in (F1)–(F3) of Part I: $d_3(de)\, 3^{\omega(d)+\omega(e)+\omega(t)}\, 4^{\omega(N)} d(N)^2 \le X^\eta$; for fixed (d, e, N) the number of tuples (s, s', t, t_1) is at most X^η; and $\sum_{k \le D} d(k)/k \le X^\eta$, $\sum_{k \le D} d(k) k^{-1/2} \le D^{1/2} X^\eta$. We also use the two bounds for a single term,

$$(5)\qquad |a_G(N')| \le T(\tilde{m}, \tilde{m}'; N') + M(\tilde{m}, \tilde{m}'; N') \ll X^{2\eta}\Big(\frac{X}{\tilde{m}\tilde{m}'} + 1\Big) \qquad (N' \le X),$$

$$(6)\qquad \sum_{n \le X} |a_G(n)| \le X^{1/2} \Big(\sum_{n \le X} |a_G(n)|^2\Big)^{1/2} \ll X\Big(1 + \frac{X}{L}\Big)^{1/2} L^\eta,$$

where $G = G_{\tilde{m}, \tilde{m}'}$ and $L = 4\tilde{m}\tilde{m}'$, the first being (21) of Part I, the second Cauchy–Schwarz, (1) and Theorem 1.1(i); for $L \le X$ the right-hand side of (6) is $\ll X^{3/2} (\tilde{m}\tilde{m}')^{-1/2+\eta}$. Let Σ denote the double sum in Theorem 1.3. Inserting (4) and splitting the tuples according to the size of $t_1 s s'$:

Tuples with $t_1 s s' > X^\varepsilon$. For each N and each tuple, (5) with $\tilde{m}\tilde{m}' > X^\varepsilon de$ gives $|a_G(N')| \ll X^{2\eta}(X^{1-\varepsilon}/(de) + 1)$. Summing over the $\le X^\eta$ tuples, over $N \le X$ and over $de \le D$ with the weights $d_3(de) \cdot 3^\omega \le X^\eta$, these tuples contribute

$$\ll X^{1+4\eta} \sum_{k \le D} d(k) \Big(\frac{X^{1-\varepsilon}}{k} + 1\Big) \ll X^{2-\varepsilon+5\eta} + X^{1+5\eta} D \ll X^{2-\varepsilon/2}.$$

Tuples with $t_1 s s' \le X^\varepsilon$. Now $t \le t_1 \le X^\varepsilon$ (as $t \mid t_1$), so t runs over at most X^ε values, t_1 over at most $d(t^2) \le X^\eta$ values, and (s, s') over at most $d(d) d(e) \le X^\eta$ values; the forms $G = G_{t_1 m, m'}$ have level $L = 4 t_1 s s' de \le 4 X^\varepsilon D \le X$, so that the right-hand side of (6) is $\ll X^{3/2} (\tilde{m}\tilde{m}')^{-1/2+\eta}$. For a fixed tuple and fixed (d, e), we drop the condition $t \mid N$ except for the count: the number of $N \le X$ with $t \mid N$ is $\le X/t$, and Cauchy–Schwarz gives

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_{\substack{N \le X \\ t \mid N}} \big(|a_G(N)| + |a_G(N/2)|\big) &\le 2\Big(\frac{X}{t}\Big)^{1/2} \Big(\sum_{n \le X} |a_G(n)|^2\Big)^{1/2} \\ &\ll \Big(\frac{X}{t}\Big)^{1/2} X\, (\tilde{m}\tilde{m}')^{-1/2+\eta} \le X^{3/2+\eta}\, t^{-1/2} (de)^{-1/2},\end{aligned}$$

using (1) in the form $\sum_{n \le X} |a_G(n)|^2 \ll X^2 \|G\|^2 / L$ and $(\tilde{m}\tilde{m}')^{-1/2+\eta} \le X^\eta (de)^{-1/2}$. Summing over $t \le X^\varepsilon$ ($\sum_t t^{-1/2} \le 2X^{\varepsilon/2}$), over the other tuple variables ($\le X^{2\eta}$), and over $de \le D$ with

the weights $\le X^{\eta}$,

$$\ll X^{3/2+4\eta+\varepsilon/2}\sum_{k\le D} d(k)k^{-1/2} \ll X^{3/2+5\eta+\varepsilon/2}D^{1/2} = X^{2-\varepsilon+5\eta} = X^{2-\varepsilon/2},$$

since $D^{1/2} = X^{1/2-3\varepsilon/2}$. Both contributions are $\ll X^{2-\varepsilon/2}$, which proves the first assertion. (The margin is small but positive: the choice $D = X^{1-3\varepsilon}$ saves $X^{-3\varepsilon/2}$ in $D^{1/2}$, of which the sum over t costs $X^{\varepsilon/2}$ and the divisor-type factors cost $X^{5\eta} = X^{\varepsilon/2}$; this is why $\eta = \varepsilon/10$.)

For the second, let $S(N)$ be the inner sum with $D = X^{1-3\varepsilon}$. The number of $N \in (X/2, X]$, $N \equiv 2 \pmod 4$, with $S(N) > X^{1-\varepsilon/4}$ is at most $\Sigma/X^{1-\varepsilon/4} \ll X^{1-\varepsilon/4}$. For the remaining N, since $N^{1-3\varepsilon} \le D$ and $X^{1-\varepsilon/4} \le (2N)^{1-\varepsilon/4} \le N^{1-\varepsilon/5}$ for large X, (3) holds. □

Remark 3.1. The exponent 1 is the balance $X^{3/2}D^{1/2} = X^2$ between the mean-square bound $X^{3/2}(de)^{-1/2}$ for the sum over N of one remainder and the number D of moduli; with a norm bound $\|G_{m,m'}\| \ll (mm')^{\beta+\varepsilon}$ in place of Theorem 1.1(i) one gets the level $1/(2(1+\beta))$ for every N (Part I, Remark 3.3) and $1/(1+2\beta)$ for almost all N; Waibel's $\beta = 1/4$ gives $2/5$ and $2/3$, and $\beta = 0$ gives $1/2$ and 1. The exceptional set $X^{1-\varepsilon/4}$ comes from Markov's inequality applied to a first moment of $S(N)$, which in turn rests on the second moment of $a_G(N)$; a bound for a higher moment would shrink it, and we do not pursue this.

3.2. **The sieve at the level** 19/20**.** Proposition 4.3 of Part I and its proof use the level of distribution only through the bound (3) (there with 2/5); they hold verbatim, for a given N, with $\theta = 2/5$ replaced by any $\theta \in (0,1)$ for which (3) holds with $N^{\theta-\varepsilon}$ in place of $N^{1-3\varepsilon}$, provided $\alpha < \beta_1 < \theta$. Lemmas 4.1 and 4.2 of Part I do not involve the level at all. Hence, for every N satisfying (3) with $3\varepsilon < 1/20$, the conclusion of Proposition 4.3 holds with $\theta = 19/20$, and the proof of Theorem 1.1 of Part I goes through with the parameters certified for $\theta = 19/20$. The script `certify_modular.py` of Part I, extended by the argument `19/20` in the repository of this paper, certifies in interval arithmetic

$$\theta = \tfrac{19}{20}, \qquad \alpha = \tfrac{2}{25}, \qquad \lambda = \tfrac{1}{3}, \qquad \beta_1 = \tfrac{69}{100},$$
$$\tfrac{1}{\lambda} + \tfrac{2}{\beta_1} = \tfrac{407}{69} < 6, \qquad \tfrac{1}{\lambda} + \tfrac{1}{\beta_1} = \tfrac{307}{69} < 5, \qquad L - \lambda R \ge 0.085058$$

(with $L \ge 0.999484$, $R \le 2.743278$, $\theta_A = 0.4740$; the output files are listed at the end of the paper). By Lemma 4.2 of Part I this gives $\Omega(n(N-n)) \le 5$ and $\max(\Omega(n), \Omega(N-n)) \le 4$, and the weight of each n counted is $w(n) = 16 \cdot 2^{\Omega(n(N-n))} \le 2^9$. As in the proof of Theorem 1.1 of Part I, the number of integers counted is at least

$$\big(0.085058 + o(1)\big)\, 2^{-9} \cdot 8\, \mathfrak{S}_r(N)\, c_{2h}\, \frac{N}{\alpha^2 (\log N)^2} \;\ge\; 0.34\, \mathfrak{S}_r(N) \frac{N}{(\log N)^2},$$

since $0.085058 \cdot 2^{-9} \cdot 8 \cdot 1.66485 \cdot (25/2)^2 = 0.3457\ldots$. The exceptional set is that of Theorem 1.3 with, say, $\varepsilon = 1/80$, so $\delta = 1/320$ is admissible. □

Remark 3.2. The same sieve gives $(8,5)$ at the level 1/2 (Part I), $(6,4)$ at 2/3 (certified: $\alpha = 3/50$, $\lambda = 1/3$, $\beta_1 = 51/100$, $L - \lambda R \ge 0.036741$) and $(5,4)$ at 19/20. The floating-point scan of Figure 2 shows that $1/\lambda + 2/\beta_1$ drops below 6 only for $\theta > 0.83$, and that the best attainable value of $1/\lambda + 1/\beta_1$ drops below 4 for $\theta > 0.88$: at $\theta = 19/20$ the minimum is 3.83, attained at $\alpha = 0.10$, $\beta_1 = 0.47$, $\lambda = 0.59$, where $1/\lambda + 2/\beta_1 = 5.96$, so that the Richert weights give $(5,3)$ for almost all N in the floating-point model, with the sifting parameter α at the edge of the scanned range. We have not certified this set, because Corollary 1.4 is in any case superseded for almost all N by the circle method (Section 1); it is an "almost all N" statement with a power-saving exceptional set and says nothing about any individual N, which is where the sieve route matters (Section 4.1).

Remark 3.3 (The vector sieve is not the natural sieve here). The sieve of Part I treats the two sides n and $N-n$ by the vector sieve of Brüdern and Fouvry, with two linear components of levels N^{θ_A} and $N^{\theta-\theta_A}$ and the lower bound $L = f_1(s_A)F_1(s_B) + F_1(s_A)f_1(s_B) - F_1(s_A)F_1(s_B)$. For $s_A, s_B \le 3$ one has $f_1/F_1(s) = \log(s-1)$, so $L > 0$ if and only if $(s_A-1)(s_B-1) > e$, and with $s = s_A + s_B$ fixed this requires $s > 2+2\sqrt{e} = 5.297\ldots$, attained at the symmetric split. The product sequence $n(N-n)$, however, is a sieve problem of dimension 2 in the classical sense: under the weight $r(n)r(N-n)$ the density of $p \mid n(N-n)$ is $2h(p)$, $\sum_{p<z} 2h(p) = 2\log\log z + O(1)$, the condition $d \mid n(N-n)$ with $(n,N)=1$ splits uniquely as $d = d_1 d_2$, $d_1 \mid n$, $d_2 \mid N-n$, and the remainder for the modulus d is $\sum_{d_1 d_2 = d} R(d_1, d_2)$, which is exactly what Theorem 3.2 of Part I and Theorem 1.3 bound (this is the reason for the weight $d_3(de)$ there). The two-dimensional sieve of Diamond, Halberstam and Richert [6] applies to it directly, with the joint level $d \le N^{\theta}$ and the sieving limit $\beta_2 = 4.2665\ldots$ in place of 5.297; its upper and lower functions F_2, f_2 should be used in place of the products of F_1, f_1 both in L and in the weight term R. Section 7 carries this out: with the sieve functions F_2, f_2 computed numerically, the two-dimensional sieve gives $(7,5)$ in place of $(8,5)$ for every N at the level $1/2$ (Theorem 7.1), $(6,4)$ at $2/3$ with a larger margin, and $(5,3)$ at $19/20$; the bound for $\max(\Omega(n), \Omega(N-n))$ comes from the same Richert weights, which see the two sides separately. For comparison, for the unweighted sequence $n(N-n)$, which has level of distribution 1 trivially, the two-dimensional weighted sieve gives $N = P_2 + P_3$ for every large even N (Wang Yuan, 1957).

4. The uniform bound and the Poincaré series

Let $L = 4mm'$ and let $P_N \in S_2(\Gamma_0(L))$, $N \ge 1$, be the Riesz representative of the N-th coefficient: the unique cusp form with

$$\langle f, P_N \rangle = \frac{a_f(N)}{4\pi N} \qquad \text{for all } f \in S_2(\Gamma_0(L)), \tag{7}$$

i.e. $P_N = (4\pi N)^{-1} \sum_{f \in \mathcal{B}} \overline{a_f(N)}\, f$ for an orthonormal basis $\mathcal{B}$. (This is the N-th Poincaré series; for weight 2 the series itself converges only conditionally, which is why we define P_N by (7).) By (11) of Part I,

$$\|P_N\|^2 = \frac{a_{P_N}(N)}{4\pi N} = \frac{1}{(4\pi N)^2} \sum_{f \in \mathcal{B}} |a_f(N)|^2 = \frac{\Delta_L(N,N)}{4\pi N},$$

where $\Delta_L(N,N)$ is the Petersson density. Hence, for $G = G_{m,m'}$,

$$|a_G(N)|^2 = (4\pi N)^2 |\langle G, P_N \rangle|^2 = 4\pi N\, \Delta_L(N,N)\, \|G\|^2 \cos^2 \angle(G, P_N), \tag{8}$$

where $\cos\angle(G,P_N) = |\langle G, P_N\rangle| / (\|G\|\,\|P_N\|)$. The identity separates the three quantities that enter any bound for $a_G(N)$: the norm $\|G\|^2$, which by Theorem 1.1(i) is $\ll L^{\varepsilon}$; the Petersson density, which is $\le C'$ for $N \le L^{1/2}$ (Part I, Lemma 2.2, Step 4) and $1 + O(N^{1/2+\varepsilon}/L)$ in general; and the alignment $\cos^2\angle(G,P_N) \le 1$. Theorem 1.1(ii) is obtained from (8) by bounding the alignment trivially: after the coprime part of N is moved into a Hecke operator (Part I, Lemma 2.2), only P_{n_2} with $n_2 \in \{1,2\}$ occurs, where the density is bounded, and the norm does the rest. Theorem 1.2 says what the alignment is on average: inserting (8) into (1) and restricting to $N \in (Y/2, Y]$,

$$\frac{1}{Y/2} \sum_{Y/2 < N \le Y} \Delta_L(N,N) \cos^2 \angle(G, P_N) \;\le\; 4e^2\Big(\frac{1}{Y} + \frac{54}{L}\Big) \;\ll\; \frac{1}{L} \qquad (Y \ge L), \tag{9}$$

the value of $\cos^2$ for a unit vector in general position in the $\asymp L$-dimensional space $S_2(\Gamma_0(L))$: on average over N, the theta series is no more aligned with the Poincaré series than a random cusp form of level L would be, and Theorem 1.1(ii) says that no single N is aligned by more than

$N^\varepsilon L/\|G\|^2 \gg L^{1-\varepsilon}$ times the average. Expanding in an orthogonal basis $\mathcal{B}^*$ of Hecke eigenforms as in Part I, Section 5.5,

$$\langle G, P_N\rangle = \sum_{\varphi\in\mathcal{B}^*} \frac{\langle G,\varphi\rangle\langle\varphi,P_N\rangle}{\|\varphi\|^2} = \frac{1}{4\pi N}\sum_{\varphi\in\mathcal{B}^*} \frac{\langle\Theta,\varphi\rangle\, a_\varphi(N)}{\|\varphi\|^2},$$

so that Theorem 1.1(ii) is the bound $\ll N^{1/2+\varepsilon}$ for this spectral sum, uniformly in m, m'; the first two versions of Part I asked for a proof through the cancellation between the coefficients $\langle\Theta,\varphi\rangle$ and $a_\varphi(N)$. The proof in Part I does not see this cancellation: it shows instead that $\sum_\varphi |\langle\Theta,\varphi\rangle|^2/\|\varphi\|^2 = \|G\|^2$ is itself small, i.e. that the theta series has a small cuspidal projection to begin with, and the spectral sum is then bounded by Cauchy–Schwarz.

4.1. **The individual bound.** Theorem 1.2 and the data (Section 5.4) say that the cancellation which the proof does not see is there for most N, and the sieve for every N would profit from it for each N. We state the strongest form suggested by the data.

Conjecture 4.1. For coprime odd m, m' and $N \geq 1$ with $(N, mm') = 1$ and $v_2(N) \leq 1$,

$$|T(m,m';N) - M(m,m';N)| = |a_{G_{m,m'}}(N)| \ \ll_\varepsilon \ N^{1/2+\varepsilon}(mm')^{-1/2+\varepsilon}.$$

In the terms of (8): $\Delta_L(N,N)\cos^2\angle(G,P_N) \ll N^\varepsilon L^{-1+\varepsilon}/\|G\|^2$, i.e. no Poincaré series P_N is aligned with G by more than $N^\varepsilon L^\varepsilon$ times the average (9).

Conjecture 4.1 is the mean-square bound (2) applied to each N separately; it is consistent with the trivial lower bound $|a_G(N)| \geq \operatorname{dist}(M, 8\mathbb{Z})$ for $N \ll L$, where $M \asymp N/(mm') \ll 1$, and with the data of Section 5.4, where the supremum over 10^6 to $4\cdot 10^6$ values of N exceeds the root mean square by a factor between 5 and 10 at every level computed. We do not know how to prove any power saving in mm' for an individual N. In the spectral form the question is a twisted first moment $\sum_\varphi \langle\Theta,\varphi\rangle a_\varphi(N)/\|\varphi\|^2$ over the forms of level L with the "long" twist $N \geq L$ (the sieve at the level θ uses $N \approx L^{1/\theta}$), outside the range $N \leq L^{1-\delta}$ in which the Petersson formula evaluates such moments. Any saving would raise the level for every N:

Proposition 4.2. *Let $0 \leq \eta \leq \frac12$ and suppose that $|a_{G_{m,m'}}(N)| \ll_\varepsilon N^{1/2+\varepsilon}(mm')^{-\eta+\varepsilon}$ for all coprime odd m, m' and all N with $(N, mm') = 1$, $v_2(N) \leq 1$. Then Theorem 3.2 of Part I holds for every $N \equiv 2 \pmod 4$ with $D = N^{\theta-\varepsilon}$, $\theta = 1/(2(1-\eta))$, i.e. $r(n)r(N-n)$ has level of distribution $1/(2(1-\eta))$. In particular, Conjecture 4.1 gives the level $1-\varepsilon$ for every N, and then the sieve of Section 3 gives, for every sufficiently large $N \equiv 2 \pmod 4$, $\Omega(n(N-n)) \leq 5$ and $\max(\Omega(n), \Omega(N-n)) \leq 4$ for at least $0.34\,\mathfrak{S}_r(N)N/(\log N)^2$ integers n.*

Proof. We follow the proof of Theorem 3.2 of Part I and only change the bound for one remainder. Each term of $R(d,e)$ is $\pm c\, a_G(N')$ for a form $G = G_{\tilde m,\tilde m'}$ with $\tilde m\tilde m' = t_1 ss'\cdot de$, where $t \mid N^\flat$, $t_1 \mid t^2$, and $N' \in \{N, N/2\}$ may have common factors with $\tilde m\tilde m'$ at the primes of t only. Lemma 2.5 of Part I reduces $a_G(N')$ to $\leq 4^{\omega(N)}d(N)$ terms $a_{G_{m_j,m_j'}}(N_j)$ with $(N_j, m_jm_j') = 1$, $N_j \mid N'$ and $m_jm_j' \geq \tilde m\tilde m'/t_1^2 \geq de/t_1^2$ (each reduction step at a prime p divides the product of the coefficients by at most p^2, and only the primes of t_1 are involved). Hence, by the hypothesis with $\varepsilon/20$ in place of ε,

$$|a_G(N')| \ll 4^{\omega(N)}d(N)\, N^{1/2+\varepsilon/20}\,(de)^{-\eta}\, t_1^{2\eta}\,(mm')^{\varepsilon/20}.$$

Put $\eta' = \varepsilon/20$. For the terms with $t_1ss' \leq N^\varepsilon$ this is $\ll N^{1/2+3\eta'+2\varepsilon\eta}(de)^{-\eta}$ by (F1) of Part I, and their total is

$$\ll N^{1/2+5\eta'+\varepsilon}\sum_{k\leq D} d(k)k^{-\eta} \ll N^{1/2+6\eta'+\varepsilon}D^{1-\eta} = N^{1/2+6\eta'+\varepsilon}N^{1/2-\varepsilon(1-\eta)} \leq N^{1-\varepsilon/2+6\eta'},$$

since $D^{1-\eta} = N^{(\theta-\varepsilon)(1-\eta)} = N^{1/2-\varepsilon(1-\eta)}$ and $1-\eta \geq \frac{1}{2}$. The terms with $t_1 ss' > N^{\varepsilon}$ are bounded by the trivial bound (5) exactly as in Part I, by $N^{1-\varepsilon+5\eta'} + N^{\theta+5\eta'}$. With $\theta \leq 1-\varepsilon$ (replace ε by $\min(\varepsilon, 1-\theta)$ if necessary) the total is $\ll N^{1-\varepsilon/2+6\eta'} \leq N^{1-\varepsilon/5}$, which is the conclusion of Theorem 3.2 of Part I with $N^{1-\varepsilon/5}$ in place of $N^{1-\varepsilon/3}$; Proposition 4.3 of Part I needs only a power saving. The last assertion is Section 3, where the parameters at the level 19/20 were certified for any N satisfying (3). □

The exponent $\theta = 1/(2(1-\eta))$ interpolates between the level 1/2 of Part I ($\eta = 0$) and the level 1 ($\eta = \frac{1}{2}$); the level 2/3, which gives $(6, 4)$ for every N with the certified parameters of Section 3, needs only $\eta = \frac{1}{4}$, i.e. a saving of $(mm')^{-1/4}$ over Theorem 1.1(ii), half of what the mean square (2) gives on average.

5. Numerical evidence

5.1. **The mean square and the norm.** The script `mean_square_check.py` computes, with the tables and the FFT convolution of `sup_error_scan.py` of Part I, the sums $S_2(Y) = \sum_{N \in \mathcal{N}_Y} |a_G(N)|^2$ over the admissible set

$$\mathcal{N}_Y = \{N \leq Y : \ (N, mm') = 1, \ v_2(N) \leq 3\},$$

on which the main term of that script is exact, for $Y = 2^{21}$ and $Y = 2^{20}$, and the estimate

$$\|G\|^2_{\mathrm{est}} = \frac{\mathrm{vol}(\Gamma_0(L)\backslash\mathbb{H})}{16\pi^2} \cdot \frac{1}{\#\mathcal{N}_Y} \sum_{N \in \mathcal{N}_Y} \frac{|a_G(N)|^2}{N}$$

suggested by the Rankin–Selberg asymptotic of Remark 2.1. Replacing $1/Y$ by $1/\#\mathcal{N}_Y$ assumes that the mean square of $|a_G(N)|^2/N$ over the excluded N (those with $(N, mm') > 1$ or $v_2(N) \geq 4$) is the same as over $\mathcal{N}_Y$; this is immaterial when mm' has only large prime factors, but introduces a bias of unknown sign for $(1, 5)$, $(9, 1)$, $(3, 5)$ and $(1, 15015)$, where 25%, 38%, 50% and 64% of the N are excluded. Table 1 shows the result at $Y = 2^{21}$, and Figure 1 the dependence on Y and on mm'.

(m, m')	mm'	$\#\mathcal{N}_Y$	$S_2(Y)/S_2(Y/2)$	$\|G\|^2_{\mathrm{est}}$	$\|G\|^2_{\mathrm{est}}/(mm')^{1/2}$	$\|G\|^2_{\mathrm{est}}/(\log mm')^2$
$(1, 5)$	5	1572864	4.001	0.74	0.33	0.29
$(9, 1)$	9	1310720	4.001	1.47	0.49	0.30
$(3, 5)$	15	1048576	4.001	3.44	0.89	0.47
$(1, 101)$	101	1946614	4.000	7.95	0.79	0.373
$(13, 29)$	377	1752262	4.001	13.09	0.67	0.372
$(1, 1009)$	1009	1964131	3.976	17.96	0.57	0.375
$(61, 67)$	4087	1904986	3.961	24.47	0.38	0.354
$(101, 103)$	10403	1927715	3.948	29.81	0.29	0.348
$(1, 15015)$	15015	754220	4.359	36.62	0.30	0.396
$(1009, 1013)$	1022117	1962192	4.559	46.87	0.046	0.244

Table 1. Mean square of the cuspidal error over the admissible $N \leq Y = 2^{21}$ (`results/mean_square_check_x21.txt`). The ratio $S_2(Y)/S_2(Y/2) \approx 4$ is the growth Y^2 of Theorem 1.2. For the first three pairs and for $(1, 15015)$ a large proportion of the N (25% to 64%) is excluded by the coprimality condition, and for the last pair $Y < L$, so that neither (1) in its Y^2/L form nor the Rankin–Selberg asymptotic applies; these rows are shown for completeness. The exact value for $(1, 5)$ is 0.5785 (Section 5.2).

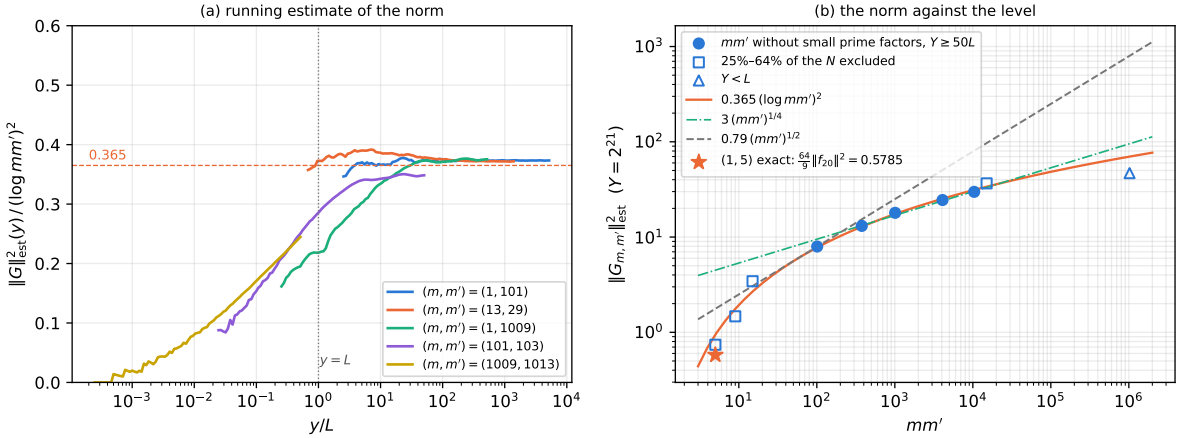


FIGURE 1. (a) The running estimate $\|G\|^2_{\mathrm{est}}(y)$, computed over the admissible $N \leq y$, divided by $(\log mm')^2$, against y/L on a logarithmic scale, for five pairs (m, m'); the plateau for $y \gg L$ is the growth Y^2 of Theorem 1.2 and the Rankin–Selberg asymptotic of Remark 2.1, and its height is the constant 0.365 of Section 5.3 (dashed). (b) $\|G_{m,m'}\|^2_{\mathrm{est}}$ at $Y = 2^{21}$ against mm', both axes logarithmic; filled circles: the five pairs with mm' free of small prime factors and $Y \geq 50L$; open squares: pairs with 25%–64% of the N excluded; triangle: $(1009, 1013)$, for which $Y < L$; star: the exact value at $(1, 5)$. The lines are $0.365(\log mm')^2$, the fit of Section 5.3, $3(mm')^{1/4}$, and $0.79(mm')^{1/2}$ (the growth allowed by Waibel's general bound, through the point $(1, 101)$). Script `plot_mean_square.py`; floating point.

5.2. **An exact check at the level 20.** The space $S_2(\Gamma_0(20))$ is one-dimensional, spanned by the newform $f_{20} = \eta(2z)^2\eta(10z)^2$ of the elliptic curve $20a1$: $y^2 = x^3 + x^2 + 4x + 4$, which is $X_0(20)$ itself (modular degree 1, Manin constant 1). Hence $G_{1,5} = c\, f_{20}$ with $c = a_G(1) = T(1, 5; 1) - M(1, 5; 1) = 4 - \frac{4}{3} = \frac{8}{3}$ (the Siegel product at $n = 1$ is $\frac{\pi^2}{5} \cdot \frac{25}{3\pi^2} \cdot \frac{4}{5}$), and $\|G_{1,5}\|^2 = \frac{64}{9}\|f_{20}\|^2$. The script `norm_level20.py` computes $\|f_{20}\|^2$ in two independent ways: from the Rankin–Selberg asymptotic $\sum_{n \leq y} a_f(n)^2/n \sim 16\pi^2\|f\|^2 y/\operatorname{vol}$, $\operatorname{vol}(\Gamma_0(20)\backslash\mathbb{H}) = 12\pi$, with the coefficients of the eta product up to 2^{20}, which gives 0.08128, 0.08128, 0.08134 at $y = 2^{16}, 2^{18}, 2^{20}$; and from the period lattice Λ of $20a1$, since $\varphi^*\omega = 2\pi i f(z)\mathrm{d}z$ gives $\|f\|^2 = \operatorname{covol}(\Lambda)/(4\pi^2)$ for a modular parametrisation of degree 1. The periods $\omega_1 = 2.824375\ldots$ (real) and $\omega_2 = 2.274165\ldots i$ of $y^2 = (x + 1)(x^2 + 4)$ are computed by quadrature, the lattice $\mathbb{Z}\omega_1 + \mathbb{Z}(\omega_1 + \omega_2)/2$ is identified as the period lattice by recomputing $g_2 = -44/3$ and $|g_3| = 296/27$ from it through E_4 and E_6, and its covolume $3.2115478\ldots$ gives $\|f_{20}\|^2 = 0.0813495\ldots$. The two values agree to four decimals. The script also checks that $T(1, 5; N) - M(1, 5; N)$ as computed by the pipeline of Part I equals $\frac{8}{3}a_f(N)$ on every admissible $N \leq 2^{20}$, to 10^{-9}. This validates the Siegel main term, the FFT computation, the Rankin–Selberg normalisation and the volume used in the estimate $\|G\|^2_{\mathrm{est}}$. The exact value $\|G_{1,5}\|^2 = 0.5785$ is below the estimate 0.74 of Table 1, as expected: the excluded N are either multiples of 5, where $|a_f(5n)| = |a_f(n)|$, or divisible by 16, where $a_f = 0$, so the admissible mean is biased upwards. With the main term made exact for every N (Section 6.4), the estimate over all $N \leq 2^{21}$ is 0.5785, in agreement with the exact value to four decimals.

5.3. **The empirical law.** The last column of Table 1 shows $\|G\|^2_{\mathrm{est}}/(\log mm')^2$. For the five pairs with $10^2 \leq mm' \leq 1.1 \cdot 10^4$, $Y \geq 50L$ and mm' free of small prime factors, it lies between

0.348 and 0.375, with mean 0.365, while the ratio to $(mm')^{1/2}$ falls from 0.79 to 0.29 and the ratio to $(mm')^{1/4}$ rises from 2.5 to 3.2 over the same range. Over a range of a factor 100 in mm' the fits $(\log mm')^2$ and $(mm')^{1/4}$ are not separated by the data alone, but Theorem 1.1(i) excludes any power, and the heuristic of Part I, Remark 2.13, that $\|G\|^2$ is a sum over the cusps of $\sum_{n\ll mm'} |b(n)|^2/n$ with $|b(n)| \approx r(\alpha)r(\beta)$ on $O(1)$ pairs, predicts $(\log mm')^2$ with a constant of the order of $\frac{1}{4\pi}\cdot 2\cdot$(number of cusp classes with a large contribution) ≈ 0.3–0.5. We therefore record

$$\|G_{m,m'}\|^2 \approx 0.37\,(\log mm')^2 \qquad (10^2 \le mm' \le 1.6\cdot 10^4),$$

and, for the root mean square of $(T-M)/\sqrt{N}$ over $N \le Y$, $Y \gg L$,

$$\mathrm{rms}^2 \approx \frac{16\pi^2\|G\|^2}{\mathrm{vol}(\Gamma_0(L)\backslash\mathbb{H})} \approx \frac{44\,(\log mm')^2}{mm'\prod_{p\mid 2mm'}(1+1/p)},$$

which reproduces the column "rms" of Table 3 of Part I (0.27 for $(101,103)$, 0.67 for $(1,1009)$). This corrects the remark in Section 5.3 of the first two versions of Part I that the root mean square "decreases like $(mm')^{-1/4}$" and that Waibel's bound "appears to be sharp": the decrease is like $(mm')^{-1/2}$ up to a logarithm, as Theorem 1.2 with Theorem 1.1(i) shows; version 3 of Part I states the corrected law. Section 6 shows what the "law" is: up to a few percent, the norm is the sum of the integrals of $|G|^2$ over the regions above the cusps, which are $\frac{1}{\pi}((\log m)^2 + (\log m')^2) + \frac{5}{\pi^2}\log m \log m' + \cdots$ with terms for the other divisors of mm'; the constant 0.37 is the average of this over the sample, and the estimates of Table 1 are themselves biased by the restriction to the admissible N (Table 3 has the unbiased values).

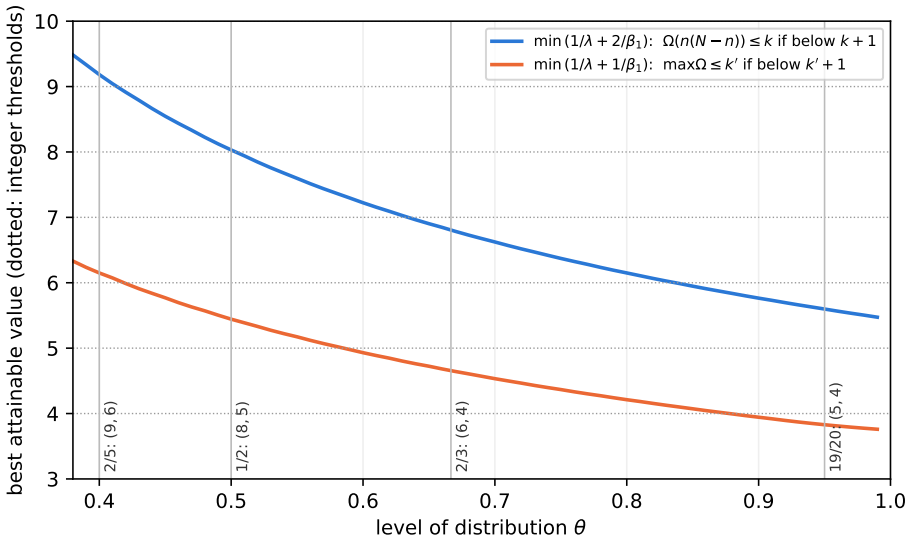


FIGURE 2. The smallest values of $1/\lambda + 2/\beta_1$ and of $1/\lambda + 1/\beta_1$ attainable with $L - \lambda R > 0$ in the sieve of Part I, as functions of the level of distribution θ (floating-point model of `modular_sieve_scan.py`, minimised over α, β_1 with $\lambda = L/R$; script `plot_sieve_thresholds.py`). The bound $\Omega(n(N-n)) \le k$, resp. $\max\Omega \le k'$, holds when the blue, resp. orange, curve is below the dotted line $k+1$, resp. $k'+1$. The vertical lines mark $\theta = 2/5$ (Waibel's bound alone) and $1/2$ (Part I, every N), $2/3$ and $19/20$ (almost all N); the parameter sets at these four levels are certified.

5.4. **The supremum over N.** Conjecture 4.1 says that the supremum of $|a_G(N)|/\sqrt{N}$ over N in a range is, up to $N^{\varepsilon}L^{\varepsilon}$, of the size of the root mean square $\approx 2.7(\log mm')(mm')^{-1/2}$ of Section 5.3. Table 2, extracted from the scans of Part I (`results/sup_error_scan_x21.txt`, `_x23.txt` there), gives the ratio of the supremum over all admissible $N \in (X/2, X]$ to the root mean square, for $X = 2^{21}$ (about 10^6 values of N per pair) and $X = 2^{23}$ (about $4 \cdot 10^6$). For the pairs with $L \le 6 \cdot 10^4$ the ratio lies between 5.4 and 9.8 and shows no trend in mm'; its mild growth from $X = 2^{21}$ to 2^{23} is the growth of the extreme value of a fixed heavy-tailed distribution with the sample size (the suprema are attained at N with 16–192 divisors, in line with the factor $d(N)$ of Deligne's bound). The pair $(9, 1)$ is special: $S_2(\Gamma_0(36))$ is spanned by the newform of the curve $36a1$, $y^2 = x^3 + 1$, which has complex multiplication, so that $a_f(p) = 0$ for $p \equiv 2 \pmod 3$ and the distribution of $a_f(N)$ is far from the Gaussian bulk of Figure 3 of Part I. The pair $(1009, 1013)$ is in the range $X < 2L$, where neither the mean square nor the supremum has reached its asymptotic regime.

(m, m')	mm'	rms	sup, $X = 2^{21}$	sup /rms	sup, $X = 2^{23}$	sup /rms
$(1, 5)$	5	1.76	14.7	8.4	17.3	9.8
$(3, 5)$	15	1.90	10.5	5.5	12.2	6.4
$(1, 101)$	101	1.40	11.8	8.4	12.1	8.6
$(13, 29)$	377	0.89	5.9	6.6	6.8	7.7
$(1, 1009)$	1009	0.67	4.4	6.5	5.3	8.0
$(61, 67)$	4087	0.38	2.5	6.5	2.4	6.3
$(101, 103)$	10403	0.27	1.9	7.3	1.8	6.7
$(1, 15015)$	15015	0.18	1.0	5.7	–	–
$(9, 1)$	9	1.76	28.7	16.3	33.8	19.2
$(1009, 1013)$	1022117	0.036	0.61	17	0.55	14

TABLE 2. The supremum of $|T(m, m'; N) - M(m, m'; N)|/\sqrt{N}$ over the admissible $N \in (X/2, X]$ of Part I, Section 5, and its ratio to the root mean square over the same N (the rms is the same to two decimals for both X). The last two pairs are the degenerate cases discussed in the text.

6. A lower bound for the norm: the regions above the cusps

Throughout this section m, m' are coprime odd positive integers, $L = 4mm'$, $\chi = \chi_{-4}$, and for $\gamma = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{smallmatrix}\right) \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Q})$ and $k \in \{1, 2\}$ we write $(f|_k\gamma)(z) = (\det\gamma)^{k/2}(cz + d)^{-k} f(\gamma z)$; thus scalar matrices act trivially, $f(mz) = m^{-k/2}(f|_k B_m)(z)$ with $B_m = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} m & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, and $(fg)|_2\gamma = (f|_1\gamma)(g|_1\gamma)$. We use $\theta^2 \in M_1(\Gamma_0(4), \chi)$, i.e. $\theta^2|_1\gamma = \chi(d)\theta^2$ for $\gamma \in \Gamma_0(4)$, and $\theta(-1/(4z)) = \sqrt{-2iz}\,\theta(z)$, which gives $\theta^2|_1 \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 4 & 0 \end{smallmatrix}\right) = -i\theta^2$.

6.1. **The Atkin–Lehner cusps.** For $Q \mid L$ with $(Q, L/Q) = 1$, an Atkin–Lehner matrix is $W_Q = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} Qa & b \\ Lc & Qd \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ with $a, b, c, d \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $\det W_Q = Q$ [1]. It normalises $\Gamma_0(L)$; hence for $f \in M_2(\Gamma_0(L))$ the form $f|_2 W_Q$ lies in $M_2(\Gamma_0(L))$ and does not depend on the choice of W_Q (two choices differ by an element of $\Gamma_0(L)$ on either side), $f \mapsto f|_2 W_Q$ is an isometry for the Petersson product which maps cusp forms to cusp forms, and it therefore preserves the orthogonal decomposition of $M_2(\Gamma_0(L))$ into the Eisenstein and the cuspidal subspace.

Lemma 6.1. *Let $Q \in \{m, 4m\}$. Then $\Theta_{m,m'}|_2 W_Q = \varepsilon_Q\, \Theta_{1,mm'}$ with $|\varepsilon_Q| = 1$, and consequently $E_{m,m'}|_2 W_Q = \varepsilon_Q E_{1,mm'}$ and $G_{m,m'}|_2 W_Q = \varepsilon_Q G_{1,mm'}$. The same holds with m and m' interchanged.*

Proof. Let first $Q = m$ and $W_m = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} ma & b \\ Lc & md \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, $mad - 4m'bc = 1$. Then $B_m W_m = m \left(\begin{smallmatrix} ma & b \\ 4m'c & d \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ with the second factor in $\Gamma_0(4)$, so $\theta^2(m\cdot)|_1 W_m = m^{-1/2}\theta^2|_1(B_m W_m) = m^{-1/2}\chi(d)\theta^2$; and $W_m = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b \\ 4m'c & md \end{smallmatrix}\right) B_m$ with the first factor in $\Gamma_0(4m')$, so $\theta^2(m'\cdot)|_1 W_m = \chi(md)\,\theta^2(m'\cdot)|_1 B_m = \chi(md)\, m^{1/2}\theta^2(mm'\cdot)$. Multiplying, $\Theta_{m,m'}|_2 W_m = \chi(m)\,\theta^2(z)\theta^2(mm'z) = \chi(m)\Theta_{1,mm'}$.

Let now $Q = 4m$ and $W_{4m} = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 4ma & b \\ Lc & 4md \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, $4mad - m'bc = 1$. Then $B_m W_{4m} = m \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 4ma & b \\ 4m'c & 4d \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, and the second factor is an Atkin–Lehner matrix W_4 for $\Gamma_0(4)$; every such matrix is $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 4 & 0 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ times an element of $\Gamma_0(4)$, so $\theta^2|_1 W_4 = \pm i\theta^2$ and $\theta^2(m\cdot)|_1 W_{4m} = \pm i\, m^{-1/2}\theta^2$. Also $W_{4m} = W_4' B_m$ with $W_4' = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 4a & b \\ 4m'c & 4md \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ an Atkin–Lehner matrix for $\Gamma_0(4m')$, and $B_{m'} W_4' = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 4a & m'b \\ 4c & 4md \end{smallmatrix}\right) B_{m'}$ with an Atkin–Lehner matrix for $\Gamma_0(4)$ in front, so $\theta^2(m'\cdot)|_1 W_4' = m'^{-1/2}(\pm i\theta^2)|_1 B_{m'} = \pm i\,\theta^2(m'\cdot)$ and $\theta^2(m'\cdot)|_1 W_{4m} = \pm i\, m^{1/2}\theta^2(mm'\cdot)$. Multiplying, $\Theta_{m,m'}|_2 W_{4m} = \pm\Theta_{1,mm'}$. The assertions on E and G follow because $|_2 W_Q$ preserves the orthogonal decomposition and $\Theta_{1,mm'} = E_{1,mm'} + G_{1,mm'}$ is that decomposition for $\Theta_{1,mm'}$ (Siegel's theorem applied to $Q_{1,mm'}$). □

We now use the formula of Part I, Lemma 2.8 (Waibel's [11, (22)]): with $\mu = [\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) : \Gamma_0(L)]$, $\tilde\mu = [\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) : \Gamma(L)]$, $\tilde\mu/\mu = L\varphi(L)$, $\mathcal{F}$ the standard fundamental domain of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$, $T = \{\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & t \\ 0 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right) : 0 \le t \le L-1\}$ and $\varrho_{a,c} = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & * \\ c & * \end{smallmatrix}\right) \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$,

$$\|G\|^2 = \frac{\mu}{\tilde\mu} \sum_{c \ (L)} \sum_{\substack{a \ (L) \\ (a,c,L)=1}} I(\varrho_{a,c}), \qquad I(\varrho) = \int_{\bigcup_{t\in T} t\mathcal{F}} \big|(G|_2\varrho)(z)\big|^2 \,\mathrm{d}x\,\mathrm{d}y, \tag{10}$$

for $G \in S_2(\Gamma_0(L))$, where (a,c) runs over coprime representatives of the residue classes. Every term is non-negative, and $\bigcup_{t\in T} t\mathcal{F} \supseteq \{-\frac12 \le x \le L - \frac12,\ y \ge 1\}$.

Lemma 6.2. *Let $Q \in \{m, 4m, m', 4m'\}$ and $a(n) = a_{G_{1,mm'}}(n)$. The terms of (10) for $G = G_{m,m'}$ with $(c, L) = L/Q$ contribute in total at least*

$$\frac{1}{4\pi} \sum_{n\ge1} \frac{|a(n)|^2}{n}\, e^{-4\pi n/Q}.$$

Proof. Let $(c, L) = L/Q$, $c = (L/Q)c_1$ with $(c_1, Q) = 1$, and $(a, c) = 1$; then $(a, L/Q) = 1$, so $(aQ, (L/Q)c_1) = 1$ and there are $b, d \in \mathbb{Z}$ with $aQd - b(L/Q)c_1 = 1$. The matrix $\varrho = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b \\ (L/Q)c_1 & Qd \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ is in $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$, has the prescribed first column, and $\varrho B_Q = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} Qa & b \\ Lc_1 & Qd \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ is an Atkin–Lehner matrix W_Q. Hence, by Lemma 6.1 and $B_Q^{-1} = Q^{-1}\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & Q \end{smallmatrix}\right)$,

$$G_{m,m'}|_2\varrho = (G_{m,m'}|_2 W_Q)|_2 B_Q^{-1} = \varepsilon_Q\, G_{1,mm'}|_2 \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & Q \end{smallmatrix}\right) = \frac{\varepsilon_Q}{Q}\, G_{1,mm'}\Big(\frac{z}{Q}\Big) = \frac{\varepsilon_Q}{Q} \sum_{n\ge1} a(n)\, e\Big(\frac{nz}{Q}\Big).$$

This function has period Q in x, and $Q \mid L$, so by Parseval over $-\frac12 \le x \le L - \frac12$,

$$I(\varrho) \ \ge\ \int_1^\infty \int_{-1/2}^{L-1/2} |G|_2\varrho|^2 \,\mathrm{d}x\,\mathrm{d}y = \frac{L}{Q^2} \sum_{n\ge1} |a(n)|^2 \int_1^\infty e^{-4\pi n y/Q}\,\mathrm{d}y = \frac{L}{4\pi Q} \sum_{n\ge1} \frac{|a(n)|^2}{n} e^{-4\pi n/Q}.$$

The number of pairs (a, c) modulo L with $(c, L) = L/Q$ and $(a, c, L) = 1$, i.e. $(a, L/Q) = 1$, is $\varphi(Q)\cdot\varphi(L/Q)\,Q = \varphi(L)Q$, and $\mu/\tilde\mu = 1/(L\varphi(L))$. Multiplying gives the assertion. □

Proof of Theorem 1.5(i). Since $mm' > 1$ and $(m, m') = 1$ we have $m \ne m'$, so the four values L/Q, $Q \in \{m, 4m, m', 4m'\}$, are distinct and the four sets of pairs (a, c) in Lemma 6.2 are disjoint. As all terms of (10) are non-negative, (i) follows by adding the four lower bounds. □

6.2. **The sum $\sum r(n)^2/n$.**

Lemma 6.3. *For $Y \ge 1$,*

$$S(Y) := \sum_{n\ge1} \frac{r(n)^2}{n}\, e^{-n/Y} = 2(\log Y)^2 + c_1 \log Y + c_2 + O(Y^{-1/2}),$$

$$c_1 = 4\gamma + 8\frac{L'}{L}(1,\chi) - 8\frac{\zeta'}{\zeta}(2) + \frac{4}{3}\log 2 = 9.758\ldots,$$

with an absolute constant c_2 ($c_2 = 6.12\ldots$ numerically); in particular $S(Y) \ge 2(\log Y)^2 - C$ for $Y \ge 1$. Moreover $\sum_{n\ge1} r(n)^2 e^{-n/X} = 4X\log X + O(X)$, so that $\sum_{n\le X} r(n)^2 \ll X\log 2X$, for $X \ge 1$.

Proof. Since $r(n)/4 = \sum_{d\mid n}\chi(d)$ is multiplicative with $r(p^k)/4 = k+1$, $\frac12(1+(-1)^k)$, 1 for $p \equiv 1,3 \pmod 4$ and $p = 2$, the series $\sum_k (r(p^k)/4)^2 x^k$ equals $(1+x)(1-x)^{-3}$, $(1-x^2)^{-1}$, $(1-x)^{-1}$ respectively, and

$$D(s) = \sum_{n\ge1}\frac{r(n)^2}{n^s} = \frac{16\,\zeta(s)^2 L(s,\chi)^2}{(1+2^{-s})\,\zeta(2s)} \qquad (\operatorname{Re} s > 1).$$

By Mellin inversion, $S(Y) = \frac{1}{2\pi i}\int_{(1)} \Gamma(w) Y^w D(1+w)\,\mathrm{d}w$. We move the contour to $\operatorname{Re} w = -\frac12$: there $\zeta(2+2w) \ne 0$ and $1/\zeta(2+2w) \ll \log(|w|+2)$, $\zeta(1+w)$ and $L(1+w,\chi)$ are $\ll (|w|+2)^{1/4}$, and $\Gamma(w)$ decays exponentially, so the integral on the new line is $O(Y^{-1/2})$. The only pole crossed is $w = 0$, of order three. With $\Gamma(w) = w^{-1}(1-\gamma w + O(w^2))$, $Y^w = 1 + w\log Y + \frac12 w^2(\log Y)^2 + O(w^3)$ and $D(1+w) = 4w^{-2}(1 + a_1 w + O(w^2))$, where $16\cdot\frac23\cdot L(1,\chi)^2/\zeta(2) = 16\cdot\frac23\cdot\frac{\pi^2}{16}\cdot\frac{6}{\pi^2} = 4$ and $a_1 = 2\gamma + 2\frac{L'}{L}(1,\chi) - 2\frac{\zeta'}{\zeta}(2) + \frac13\log 2$, the residue is $2(\log Y)^2 + 4(a_1 - \gamma)\log Y + c_2$. The numerical value uses $L'(1,\chi)/L(1,\chi) = \gamma + 2\log 2 + 3\log\pi - 4\log\Gamma(\frac14) = 0.2456\ldots$ and $\zeta'(2)/\zeta(2) = -0.5700\ldots$. Since $c_1 > 0$, $S(Y) \ge 2(\log Y)^2 + c_2 - O(1)$ for $Y \ge 1$. The last assertion is the same argument for $\frac{1}{2\pi i}\int \Gamma(w) X^w D(w)\mathrm{d}w$ with the contour moved to $\operatorname{Re} w = \frac34$, where only the double pole at $w = 1$ is crossed, and $\sum_{n\le X} r(n)^2 \le e\sum_n r(n)^2 e^{-n/X}$. □

6.3. **The main term for small n.**

Lemma 6.4. *Let $Q = Q_{m,m'}$ and $n \ge 1$. Then $\beta_2(n) \le 2$; $\beta_p(n) \le \sigma_{-1}(p^{v_p(n)})$ for $p \nmid 2mm'$; and $\beta_p(n) \le 7\,(\min(v_p(n), v_p(mm')) + 1)$ for $p \mid mm'$, while $\beta_p(n) \le 1 + 1/p$ for $p \mid mm'$, $p \nmid n$. Consequently, for $Y \ge 1$,*

$$\sum_{n\ge1} \frac{r(n)\,M(m,m';n)}{n}\, e^{-n/Y} \;\ll\; \frac{Y}{mm'}\,\log(2Y)\,(\log\log 3mm')^C$$

with an absolute constant C.

Proof. For a prime p, $a \ge 1$ and $t \in \mathbb{Z}$ let $N_2(t;p^a) = \#\{(x,y) \bmod p^a :\ x^2 + y^2 \equiv t\}$. We claim

$$N_2(t;p^a) \le 2\,(\min(v_p(t), a) + 1)\,p^a \quad (p \text{ odd}), \qquad N_2(t;2^a) \le 2^{a+1}. \tag{11}$$

For odd p, the solutions with $(x,y) \not\equiv (0,0) \pmod p$ are non-singular and lift from p to p^a with multiplicity p^{a-1}; modulo p there are $p - \chi(p) \le 2p$ of them if $p \nmid t$ and $2(p-1)$ or 0 if $p \mid t$. The solutions with $x \equiv y \equiv 0 \pmod p$ exist only if $p^2 \mid t$ and are $p^2 N_2(t/p^2; p^{a-2})$ in number for $a \ge 2$. Hence $N_2(t;p^a) \le 2p^a + p^2 N_2(t/p^2; p^{a-2})$, and (11) follows by induction on a ($N_2(t;p) \le 2p$, $N_2(t;1) = 1$). For $p = 2$ and $a \ge 3$: if $t \equiv 1 \pmod 4$, exactly one of x, y is odd, and since the odd squares modulo 2^a are the residues $\equiv 1 \pmod 8$, each taken four times, while $y^2 \equiv 0$ or $4 \pmod 8$ according as $4 \mid y$ or not, there are $2\cdot 4\cdot 2^{a-2} = 2^{a+1}$ solutions; if

$t \equiv 2 \pmod 8$ both are odd and there are $4 \cdot 4 \cdot 2^{a-3} = 2^{a+1}$ solutions; if $t \equiv 3 \pmod 4$ or $t \equiv 6 \pmod 8$ there are none; and if $4 \mid t$ both are even and $N_2(t; 2^a) = 4N_2(t/4; 2^{a-2})$, so (11) follows by induction from $N_2(t; 2^a) \le 2^{a+1}$ for $a \le 2$, which one checks by hand.

Now $\beta_2(n) = \lim_a 2^{-3a} \sum_{(z,w) \bmod 2^a} N_2\big((n - m'(z^2+w^2))\bar m; 2^a\big) \le \lim_a 2^{-3a} \cdot 2^{2a} \cdot 2^{a+1} = 2$, where $\bar m$ is an inverse of m modulo 2^a. For $p \nmid 2mm'$ the formula $\beta_p(n) = (1-p^{-2})\sigma_{-1}(p^{v_p(n)})$ is (6) of Part I. Let $p \mid mm'$, say $p^e \parallel m$ with $e \ge 1$, $p \nmid m'$, and $p^k \parallel n$. By (11), with $X = x^2 + y^2$,

$$\beta_p(n) = \lim_a p^{-3a} \sum_{(x,y) \bmod p^a} N_2\big((n - mX)\bar m'; p^a\big) \le 2\Big(1 + \sum_{i \ge 1} \mathrm{Prob}_{(x,y)}\big(p^i \mid n - mX\big)\Big),$$

the probability referring to (x, y) uniform modulo p^a with $a \ge i$. For $i \le \min(k, e)$ the probability is 1. If $k < e$ it is 0 for $i > k$. If $k \ge e$ and $i > e$, then $p^i \mid n - mX$ if and only if $X \equiv n_1 \pmod{p^{i-e}}$ with $n_1 = (n/p^e)(m/p^e)^{-1}$, which has probability $N_2(n_1; p^{i-e})p^{-2(i-e)} \le 2(i-e+1)p^{-(i-e)}$ by (11), and $\sum_{j \ge 1} 2(j+1)p^{-j} \le \frac{5}{2}$ for $p \ge 3$. Hence $\beta_p(n) \le 2(\min(k,e) + \frac{7}{2}) \le 7(\min(k,e)+1)$; for $k = 0$ the exact value $1 - \chi(p)/p$ is (7) of Part I.

For the sum, write $M(m, m'; n) = \pi^2 n\, \beta(n)/(mm')$ with $\beta(n) = \prod_p \beta_p(n)$, so that the sum is $\frac{\pi^2}{mm'} \sum_n r(n)\beta(n)e^{-n/Y}$, and $\beta(n) \le 2\,\sigma_{-1}(n) \prod_{p \mid mm'}(1 + \frac{1}{p}) \prod_{p \mid (n, mm')} 7(v_p(n)+1)$. Write $n = gk$ with g composed of the primes of mm' and $(k, mm') = 1$; then $r(n) \le 4d(g)d(k)$, $\sigma_{-1}(n) \le 2^{\omega(g)}\sigma_{-1}(k)$, and $\sum_{k \le x} d(k)\sigma_{-1}(k) \ll x \log 2x$ (write $\sigma_{-1}(k) = \sum_{u \mid k} 1/u$ and sum over u first). Therefore

$$\sum_n r(n)\beta(n)e^{-n/Y} \;\ll\; \prod_{p \mid mm'} \Big(1 + \frac{1}{p}\Big) \sum_g \frac{7^{\omega(g)}\, 2^{\omega(g)}\, d(g)^2}{g}\, Y \log(2Y) \;\ll\; Y \log(2Y) \prod_{p \mid mm'} \Big(1 + \frac{C}{p}\Big),$$

since $\sum_{j \ge 1} 14(j+1)^2 p^{-j} \le C/p$ for $p \ge 3$, and $\prod_{p \mid mm'}(1 + C/p) \le \exp(C \sum_{p \mid mm'} 1/p) \ll (\log\log 3mm')^C$. □

Proof of Theorem 1.5(ii). Fix $Q \in \{m, 4m, m', 4m'\}$ with $Q \ge 4\pi$ and put $Y = Q/(4\pi) \ge 1$; note $Y \le \max(m, m')/\pi \le mm'/\pi$. Keep only $n < mm'$ in the inner sum of (i), where $a(n) = r(n) - M(1, mm'; n)$ and $M \ge 0$, so that $|a(n)|^2 \ge r(n)^2 - 2r(n)M(1, mm'; n)$:

$$\sum_{n \ge 1} \frac{|a(n)|^2}{n} e^{-n/Y} \;\ge\; S(Y) - \sum_{n \ge mm'} \frac{r(n)^2}{n} e^{-n/Y} - 2 \sum_{n \ge 1} \frac{r(n) M(1, mm'; n)}{n} e^{-n/Y}.$$

By Lemma 6.3, $S(Y) \ge 2(\log Y)^2 - C$, and the tail is at most

$$\sum_{j \ge 0} e^{-\pi 2^j} \frac{1}{2^j mm'} \sum_{n < 2^{j+1} mm'} r(n)^2 \;\ll\; \sum_{j \ge 0} e^{-\pi 2^j} \log(2^{j+2} mm') \;\ll\; \log(2mm').$$

By Lemma 6.4 with (m, m') replaced by $(1, mm')$, the last sum is at most a constant times $(Y/mm')\log(2Y)(\log\log 3mm')^C$, which is at most $\log(2mm')(\log\log 3mm')^C$ because $Y/mm' \le 1/\min(m, m') \le 1$. Summing over the four Q and using

$$2\big(\log(m/4\pi)\big)^2 + 2\big(\log(m/\pi)\big)^2 \;\ge\; 4(\log m)^2 - 4\log(4\pi^2)\log m$$

(and the same for m'), while the terms with $Q < 4\pi$, if any, are dropped and the corresponding $(\log m)^2 \le (\log 12)^2$ is absorbed in the constant, (i) gives

$$\|G_{m,m'}\|^2 \;\ge\; \frac{1}{\pi}\Big((\log m)^2 + (\log m')^2\Big) - \frac{\log(4\pi^2)}{\pi} \log(mm') - C \log(2mm')(\log\log 3mm')^C,$$

which is (ii); the second inequality in (ii) is $(\log m)^2 + (\log m')^2 \ge \frac{1}{2}(\log mm')^2$. □

6.4. **All cusps, numerically.** For square-free m, m' the computation of Lemma 6.2 can be carried out at every cusp. The cusps of $\Gamma_0(L)$ are then in bijection with the divisors d of L (one cusp of denominator d for each d, since $(d, L/d) \le 2$), and we write $d = d_2\delta$ with $d_2 \mid 4$, $\delta \mid mm'$, $\delta_m = (\delta, m)$, $\delta_{m'} = (\delta, m')$, and

$$A = \delta_m \frac{m'}{\delta_{m'}}, \qquad B = \delta_{m'} \frac{m}{\delta_m}, \qquad AB = mm', \quad (A, B) = 1.$$

The cusps with $d_2 \in \{1, 4\}$ are the images of ∞ under the Atkin–Lehner involutions $W_{L/d}$, their widths are $L/d = 4mm'/\delta$ and mm'/δ, and the proof of Lemma 6.1, applied prime by prime, gives $G_{m,m'}|_2 W_{L/d} = \varepsilon\, G_{A,B}$ with $|\varepsilon| = 1$ (the odd part of L/d moves the primes of δ_m from the first block to the second and those of $\delta_{m'}$ from the second to the first; the 2-part contributes a sign). The two cusps of Theorem 1.5 with the pair $(1, mm')$ are $\delta \in \{m, m'\}$. At the cusp with $d_2 = 2$, the function θ^2 is transformed into θ_2^2, $\theta_2(z) = \sum_{x \text{ odd}} e(x^2 z/4)$ (from $\theta^2|_1 \left(\begin{smallmatrix} \frac12 & 0 \\ 1 & \end{smallmatrix}\right) = \theta_2^2$, which follows from the transformation formulae of $\theta_3, \theta_4, \theta_2$ under $z \mapsto -1/(4z)$), and $\Theta_{m,m'}$ into $(mm'/\delta)^{-1} \sum_n T^{\mathrm{odd}}(A, B; n) e(\delta n z/(4mm'))$, where T^{odd} counts the representations of n by $Q_{A,B}$ with all four coordinates odd; the Eisenstein part of this expansion is given by Siegel's theorem for the coset $(1 + 2\mathbb{Z})^4$ of $2\mathbb{Z}^4$, i.e. by $M^{\mathrm{odd}}(A, B; n) = \frac{\pi^2 n}{AB} \cdot \frac12 [n \equiv 2(A + B)\ (8)] \prod_{p>2} \beta_p(n)$ (for $(A, B) = (1, 1)$ this is Jacobi's formula $16\sigma(n/4)$ for the number of representations of $n \equiv 4 \pmod 8$ as a sum of four odd squares). Integrating $|G|^2$ over the region above each cusp as in Lemma 6.2 gives

$$\|G_{m,m'}\|^2 \ \ge\ \Lambda(m, m') := \sum_{\delta \mid mm'} \Big[\frac{1}{4\pi} \sum_{n \ge 1} \frac{|a_{G_{A,B}}(n)|^2}{n} \big(e^{-\pi\delta n/mm'} + e^{-4\pi\delta n/mm'} \big) + \frac{1}{\pi} \sum_{n \ge 1} \frac{|T^{\mathrm{odd}}(A, B; n) - M^{\mathrm{odd}}(A, B; n)|^2}{n}\, e^{-\pi\delta n/mm'} \Big], \tag{12}$$

where A, B depend on δ as above. The regions above all the cusps have total area equal to the sum of the widths, which is $\mu = L \prod_{p \mid L} (1 + 1/p)$, i.e. the fraction $3/\pi = 0.955$ of $\mathrm{vol}(\Gamma_0(L)\backslash\mathbb{H})$; the rest of the fundamental domain lies below height 1 at every cusp.

The script `cusp_lower_bound.py` evaluates (12). It needs the main terms $M(A, B; n)$ and $M^{\mathrm{odd}}(A, B; n)$ for *every* n, not only the admissible ones: the module `local_densities.py` computes the densities at the primes $p \mid AB$ dividing n by the recursion $\beta_p(Q_{A,B}; pn') = 2(1 - \frac1p)[p \equiv 1\ (4)] + \frac1p \beta_p(Q_{A/p,pB}; n')$ for $p \mid A$ (the non-singular solutions have $(z, w) \not\equiv 0$, the singular ones reduce to the form $Q_{A/p,pB}$), which gives $\beta_p(n) = (1 + \frac1p) p^{-k}$ for $p \equiv 3$ and $2 - (1 + \frac1p) p^{-k}$ for $p \equiv 1 \pmod 4$, $k = v_p(n)$; the 2-adic density by sorting the solutions by the parities of (x, y) and (z, w), which gives $\beta_2(n) = \frac14 \beta_2(n/4) + \frac12 [A \equiv B\ (4)][v_2(n) = 2] + [A \not\equiv B\ (4)](1 + \frac12 [v_2(n) \ge 3])$ for $v_2(n) \ge 2$; and $\beta_2^{\mathrm{odd}}(n) = \frac12 [n \equiv 2(A + B)\ (8)]$. These formulae are checked exactly: at the levels 4 and 12, where there are no cusp forms, $T = M$ and $T^{\mathrm{odd}} = M^{\mathrm{odd}}$ for every $n \le 2^{17}$ to 10^{-9}, and at the level 20, $T - M = \frac83 a_{f_{20}}(n)$ for every $n \le 2^{17}$ (Section 5.2 had this only for the admissible n), while the mean square of $T^{\mathrm{odd}} - M^{\mathrm{odd}}$ grows like Y^2 as for a cusp form. With the exact main term the Rankin–Selberg estimate of Section 5 can be taken over all $n \le Y$; this is the column $\|G\|^2$ of Table 3, and for $(1, 5)$ it is 0.5785, the exact value of Section 5.2.

(m,m')	mm'	$\|G\|^2$	Tab. 1	Λ_{AL}	Λ_{odd}	Λ	$\Lambda/\|G\|^2$	Thm 1.5(i)	$\frac{1}{\pi}(\log^2 m+\log^2 m')$
$(1,5)$	5	0.5785	0.74	0.496	0.046	0.543	0.938	0.496	0.82
$(3,5)$	15	2.058	3.44	1.799	0.136	1.936	0.940	1.061	1.21
$(3,7)$	21	2.481	4.02	2.186	0.167	2.352	0.948	1.183	1.59
$(5,7)$	35	4.109	4.82	3.555	0.314	3.869	0.942	2.154	2.03
$(1,101)$	101	7.429	7.95	7.147	0.100	7.247	0.976	7.147	6.78
$(13,29)$	377	12.423	13.09	10.795	1.033	11.828	0.952	6.639	5.70
$(15,77)$	1155	21.779	27.93	19.620	1.340	20.960	0.962	9.596	8.34
$(1,1009)$	1009	16.937	17.96	16.572	0.106	16.678	0.985	16.572	15.23
$(61,67)$	4087	24.704	24.47	21.411	2.000	23.411	0.948	12.875	11.01
$(101,103)$	10403	30.385	29.81	26.470	2.447	28.917	0.952	15.847	13.62
$(105,143)$	15015	47.140	49.50	40.622	3.186	43.807	0.929	17.079	14.73
$(1,15015)^*$	15015	43.233	43.54	44.610	0.230	44.839	1.037	30.818	29.44
$(1009,1013)^*$	1022117	57.730	61.23	58.545	5.271	63.816	1.105	34.469	30.47

TABLE 3. The lower bound (12) and its parts (`results/cusp_lower_bound.txt`, `_large.txt`): Λ_{AL} is the sum over the Atkin–Lehner cusps ($d_2\in\{1,4\}$), Λ_{odd} the sum over the cusps with $d_2=2$, Λ their sum, "Thm 1.5(i)" the right-hand side of Theorem 1.5(i) (the four cusps with $\delta\in\{m,m'\}$), and the last column its leading term. $\|G\|^2$ is the Rankin–Selberg estimate over all $n\le 2^{21}$ with the exact main term (2^{24} for the two pairs marked *), and "Tab. 1" the estimate over the admissible n of Section 5 (for $(3,7)$, $(5,7)$, $(15,77)$, $(105,143)$ computed here in the same way). For the two pairs marked * the estimate has not converged ($Y/L=280$ and 4; Table 1 has $S_2(Y)/S_2(Y/2)=4.36$ and 4.56 for them), and the lower bound is the better information. Floating point.

Table 3 shows the following.

(a) For the ten pairs with $Y\ge 50L$, the regions above the cusps carry between 93.8% and 98.5% of the norm (for $(105,143)$, with $Y/L=35$, 92.9%), about their share 95.5% of the area: the function $y^2|G|^2$ has no excess mass in the remaining 4.5% of the fundamental domain, near the elliptic points and in the "corners" between the cusps. The lower bound (12) is thus nearly an equality, and an asymptotic formula for $\|G_{m,m'}\|^2$ is a question about the lower part of the fundamental domain only.

(b) The four cusps of Theorem 1.5(i) alone give 98% for $m=1$, where they are all the Atkin–Lehner cusps, and about half for $mm'=pq$; the rest comes from the pair (m,m') itself at the cusps with $\delta=1$ (widths $4mm'$ and mm', and the cusp of denominator 2): for $(13,29)$, $4.16+1.03$ out of 12.42.

(c) For the cusps with $\delta=1$, $T(m,m';n)$, $n\ll mm'$, is a sum of at most $1+n/mm'$ products $r(\alpha)r(\beta)$ with $m\alpha+m'\beta=n$; replacing $r(\alpha)^2, r(\beta)^2$ by their mean values $4\log\alpha$, $4\log\beta$ (Lemma 6.3) gives for their Atkin–Lehner part

$$\frac{16}{4\pi}\iint_{u,v>0}\frac{\log(m'u)\log(mv)}{u+v}\bigl(e^{-\pi(u+v)}+e^{-4\pi(u+v)}\bigr)\mathrm{d}u\,\mathrm{d}v=\frac{5}{\pi^2}\log m\log m'+O(\log mm'),$$

since $\iint e^{-c(u+v)}(u+v)^{-1}\mathrm{d}u\,\mathrm{d}v=1/c$: 4.38, 8.76, 10.84 against the computed 4.16, 8.54, 10.62 for $(13,29)$, $(61,67)$, $(101,103)$.

(d) The leading term $\frac{1}{\pi}((\log m)^2+(\log m')^2)$ of Theorem 1.5(i) is 85–95% of the right-hand side of (i) for $mm'\ge 100$; the difference is the term $c_1\log Y+c_2$ of Lemma 6.3 at the four cusps, which is still large at $Y\approx 10^2$–10^3.

(e) When mm' has several prime factors, the other divisors contribute: for $m=1$ and $\delta\mid m'$ the cusps with the pair $(m'/\delta,\delta)$ and width m'/δ see $T(m'/\delta,\delta;n)=r(n/\delta)$ for $n<m'/\delta$,

hence contribute about $\frac{1}{\pi\delta}\big(\log\frac{m'}{\delta^2}\big)_+^2$: for $(1,15015)$ the divisors $\delta=3,5,7,11,13$ give 6.72, 2.88, 1.78, 0.82, 0.57 (against 5.84, 2.61, 1.49, 0.67, 0.49 from the formula), which is why this pair has the largest ratio $\|G\|^2/(\log mm')^2$ in Table 1.

In short, $\|G_{m,m'}\|^2$ is, to within a few percent, $\frac{1}{\pi}((\log m)^2+(\log m')^2)+\frac{5}{\pi^2}\log m\log m'$ plus the contribution of the cusp of denominator 2 and of the other divisors of mm', plus lower-order terms; its ratio to $(\log mm')^2$ tends to $1/\pi$ for $(1,m')$ and to $\frac{1}{2\pi}+\frac{5}{4\pi^2}+\cdots$ for $m\approx m'$ prime, with lower-order terms that are still substantial at $mm'\approx 10^4$. The constant 0.37 of Section 5.3 is the average of these ratios over the sample.

7. The two-dimensional sieve: $(7,5)$ for every N

Remark 3.3 observed that the product $n(N-n)$ is a sieve problem of dimension 2, with the level of distribution $N^{1/2-\varepsilon}$ of Part I, Theorem 3.2, and that the two-dimensional sieve of Diamond, Halberstam and Richert has the sieving limit $\beta_2=4.2665$ against $2+2\sqrt{e}=5.297$ for the vector sieve of Part I. Here we carry this out.

7.1. **The sieve functions of dimension two.** We recall the definitions [7], [6, Chapters 6 and 9]. For $\kappa\ge 1$ the Ankeny–Onishi function σ_κ is the continuous solution of

$$\sigma_\kappa(s)=\frac{s^\kappa}{(2e^\gamma)^\kappa\,\Gamma(\kappa+1)}\quad(0<s\le 2),\qquad \big(s^{-\kappa}\sigma_\kappa(s)\big)'=-\kappa s^{-\kappa-1}\sigma_\kappa(s-2)\quad(s>2),$$

and the sieve functions F_κ, f_κ are the solutions of

$$\begin{aligned} &F_\kappa(s)=\frac{1}{\sigma_\kappa(s)}\quad(0<s\le\alpha_\kappa), && \big(s^\kappa F_\kappa(s)\big)'=\kappa s^{\kappa-1}f_\kappa(s-1)\quad(s>\alpha_\kappa),\\ &f_\kappa(s)=0\quad(0<s\le\beta_\kappa), && \big(s^\kappa f_\kappa(s)\big)'=\kappa s^{\kappa-1}F_\kappa(s-1)\quad(s>\beta_\kappa),\end{aligned}\tag{13}$$

where $\alpha_\kappa,\beta_\kappa$ are the constants for which $F_\kappa(s),f_\kappa(s)\to 1$; $\alpha_1=\beta_1=2$ and F_1,f_1 are the linear sieve functions, and $\alpha_\kappa>\beta_\kappa>2$ for $\kappa>1$. F_κ decreases and f_κ increases, $F_\kappa=1+O(e^{-s})$, $f_\kappa=1-O(e^{-s})$, and both are Lipschitz: $|F_\kappa(s_1)-F_\kappa(s_2)|,|f_\kappa(s_1)-f_\kappa(s_2)|\le\kappa|s_2-s_1|/(s_1\sigma_\kappa(1))$ for $1\le s_1<s_2$ [6, Lemma 6.2]. The sieve theorem [6, Theorem 9.1] states, for a sequence $\mathcal{A}$ with $|\mathcal{A}_d|=X\omega(d)/d+R_d$, ω multiplicative with $\sum_{w\le p<z}\omega(p)\log p/p\le\kappa\log(z/w)+O(1)$, $V(z)=\prod_{p<z}(1-\omega(p)/p)$ and $2\le z\le y$,

$$\begin{aligned} S(\mathcal{A},z)&\le XV(z)\Big(F_\kappa\Big(\frac{\log y}{\log z}\Big)+E\Big)+2\sum_{\substack{m\mid P(z)\\ m<y}}4^{\omega(m)}|R_m|,\\ S(\mathcal{A},z)&\ge XV(z)\Big(f_\kappa\Big(\frac{\log y}{\log z}\Big)-E\Big)-2\sum_{\substack{m\mid P(z)\\ m<y}}4^{\omega(m)}|R_m|,\end{aligned}\tag{14}$$

with $E=O\big((\log\log y)^2(\log y)^{-1/(2\kappa+2)}\big)$.

The constants $\alpha_\kappa,\beta_\kappa$ are determined by two conditions, which we formulate with the adjoint functions p_κ,q_κ, the solutions of $s^\kappa p'(s)=-\kappa(s+1)^{\kappa-1}p(s+1)$ with $p(s)\sim s^{-\kappa}$ and of $s^\kappa q'(s)=\kappa(s+1)^{\kappa-1}q(s+1)$ with $q(s)\sim s^\kappa$ (Booker and Browning [2] use the equivalent $(up)'=\kappa(p(u)-p(u+1))$, $(uq)'=\kappa(q(u)+q(u+1))$). For $P=F_\kappa+f_\kappa$ and $Q=F_\kappa-f_\kappa$ the

quantities

$$\Phi_P(s) = s^\kappa P(s)p(s) + \kappa\int_{s-1}^{s} (u+1)^{\kappa-1}P(u)p(u+1)\,\mathrm{d}u,$$
$$\Phi_Q(s) = s^\kappa Q(s)q(s) - \kappa\int_{s-1}^{s} (u+1)^{\kappa-1}Q(u)q(u+1)\,\mathrm{d}u$$

are constant for $s \ge \max(\alpha_\kappa,\beta_\kappa)+1$, by the differential-delay equations, and $P\to 2$, $Q\to 0$ if and only if $\Phi_P = 2$ and $\Phi_Q = 0$ (a solution Q of its equation which is not the sieve solution decays only like $s^{-2\kappa}$, and then $\Phi_Q \neq 0$). The script `dhr_sieve.py` solves (13) for given (α,β) on a grid of step $1/2000$, computes p, q by backward integration from their asymptotic series, and solves $\Phi_P = 2$, $\Phi_Q = 0$ for (α,β). For $\kappa = 1$ it returns $\alpha = \beta = 2$ and reproduces $F_1(3) = 2e^\gamma/3$, $f_1(4) = 2e^\gamma\log 3/4$ and $f_1(5/2)$ to six decimals. For $\kappa = 2$ it returns

$$\alpha_2 = 5.357727, \qquad \beta_2 = 4.266450,$$

which agree to 10^{-8} with the values $\alpha_2 = 5.35772744559\ldots$, $\beta_2 = 4.26645028414\ldots$ computed in ball arithmetic by Booker and Browning [2] (truncated at 20 decimals there), and with $\beta_2 = 4.2665$ of [7]; also $F_2(s) = 2(2e^\gamma)^2/s^2 = 25.378/s^2$ on $(0,2]$. Refining the grid to $1/4000$ changes α_2,β_2 by $3\cdot 10^{-8}$ and the values of F_2, f_2 below by less than 10^{-7}. Some values:

s	2	3	4	4.5	5	6	8	10
$F_2(s)$	6.3444	2.9164	1.8364	1.5704	1.3928	1.1136	1.0027	1.00002
$f_2(s)$	0	0	0	0.2403	0.5790	0.8844	0.9973	0.99998

7.2. **The weighted sieve.** We keep the setting of Part I, Section 4: $N \equiv 2 \pmod 4$ large, $\mathcal{A} = \{n \le N :\ (n,N) = 1\}$ with the weights $w(n) = r(n)r(N-n)$, $X_N = \sum_{n\in\mathcal{A}} w(n)$ and, for square-free d with $(d,2N) = 1$,

$$\sum_{\substack{n\in\mathcal{A}\\ d\mid n(N-n)}} w(n) = X_N\prod_{p\mid d} 2h(p) + R_d, \qquad R_d = \sum_{d_1d_2=d} R(d_1,d_2;N),$$

since $(n,N) = 1$ forces $d \mid n(N-n)$ to split uniquely as $d_1 \mid n$, $d_2 \mid N-n$ (Remark 3.3); here $h(p) = (2p-1)/(p(p+1))$ for $p\equiv 1$ and $h(q) = 1/(q(q-1))$ for $q\equiv 3 \pmod 4$, as in Part I, (18). Therefore $\sum_{d\le D} d_3(d)|R_d|$ is bounded by the sum of Part I, Theorem 3.2, which is $\ll N^{1-\varepsilon/3}$ for $D = N^{1/2-\varepsilon}$, and the same holds for the sums over $d \le D/p$ needed for the sequences $\mathcal{A}_p = \{n\in\mathcal{A} :\ p \mid n(N-n)\}$. The density $\omega(p) = 2h(p)p$ satisfies $\sum_{p<z} 2h(p) = 2\log\log z + O(1)$, so the sieve has dimension $\kappa = 2$ in the sense of (14). Let $0 < a < b < \frac12$, $\lambda > 0$, $z = N^a$, $y = N^b$, and consider

$$W = \sum_{\substack{n\in\mathcal{A}\\ (n(N-n),P(z))=1}} w(n)\Big(1 - \lambda\sum_{\substack{z\le p<y\\ p\mid n(N-n)}}\Big(1-\frac{\log p}{\log y}\Big)\Big) = S(\mathcal{A},z) - \lambda\sum_{z\le p<y}\Big(1-\frac{\log p}{\log y}\Big)S(\mathcal{A}_p,z).$$

By (14) with the lower function for $\mathcal{A}$ at the level $N^{1/2-\varepsilon}$ and the upper function for $\mathcal{A}_p$ at the level $N^{1/2-\varepsilon}/p$, and with the passage from the sum over p to an integral as in Part I, Section 4,

$$W \ \ge\ X_N V(z)\big(L_2 - \lambda R_2 - o(1)\big), \qquad L_2 = f_2\Big(\frac{1}{2a}\Big), \qquad R_2 = 2\int_a^b\Big(1-\frac{t}{b}\Big)F_2\Big(\frac{1/2-t}{a}\Big)\frac{\mathrm{d}t}{t} \tag{15}$$

(the $-\varepsilon$ in the level is absorbed by the Lipschitz continuity of f_2, F_2). On the other hand, as in Part I, Lemma 4.2, the n with $p^2 \mid n(N-n)$ for some $p \ge z$ contribute $o(X_NV(z))$, and for the others the weight is positive only if $\Omega(n(N-n)) < 1/\lambda + 2/b$ and $\max(\Omega(n),\Omega(N-n)) < 1/\lambda + 1/b$, because $\sum_{p\mid n}(1-\log p/\log y) \ge \Omega(n) - \log n/\log y \ge \Omega(n) - 1/b$ and likewise for $N-n$, while the terms with $p \ge y$ are ≤ 0 and all prime factors are $\ge z$. Hence, exactly as in the proof of

Theorem 1.1 of Part I, if $L_2-\lambda R_2>0$, then for every large $N\equiv 2 \pmod 4$ the number of $n\in\mathcal{A}$ with n, $N-n$ products of distinct primes $\equiv 1 \pmod 4$ exceeding N^a, $\Omega(n(N-n))\le k$ and $\max(\Omega(n),\Omega(N-n))\le k'$, where $k+1\ge 1/\lambda+2/b$ and $k'+1\ge 1/\lambda+1/b$, is at least

$$\big(L_2-\lambda R_2-o(1)\big)\,2^{-(k+4)}\cdot 8\,\mathfrak{S}_r(N)\,c_{2h}\,\frac{N}{a^2(\log N)^2}, \tag{16}$$

with $c_{2h}=1.66485$ as there (the factor $2^{-(k+4)}$ is $1/\max w(n)$, since $r(n)=4\cdot 2^{\omega(n)}$ for such n).

Theorem 7.1. *Let $a=1/18$, $b=2/5$, $\lambda=1/3$, and suppose that*

$$f_2(9)\;\ge\;0.9995,\qquad 2\int_{1/18}^{2/5}\Big(1-\frac{5t}{2}\Big)F_2(9-18t)\,\frac{\mathrm{d}t}{t}\;\le\;2.63. \tag{17}$$

Then for every sufficiently large $N\equiv 2 \pmod 4$,

$$\#\big\{1\le n<N:\ n=x^2+y^2,\ N-n=z^2+w^2,\ \Omega(n(N-n))\le 7,\ \max(\Omega(n),\Omega(N-n))\le 5\big\}\\ \ge\;0.25\,\mathfrak{S}_r(N)\frac{N}{(\log N)^2},$$

the integers counted being coprime to N and products of distinct primes $\equiv 1 \pmod 4$ exceeding $N^{1/18}$. The computed values are $f_2(9)=0.99972$ and 2.6238 for the integral, so (17) holds with margins $2\cdot 10^{-4}$ and $6\cdot 10^{-3}$.

Proof. With these parameters $1/\lambda+2/b=8$ and $1/\lambda+1/b=5.5$, so $k=7$ and $k'=5$ are admissible in (16), and $L_2-\lambda R_2\ge 0.9995-2.63/3=0.1228$ by (17); then (16) gives the constant $0.1228\cdot 2^{-11}\cdot 8\cdot 1.66485\cdot 18^2=0.2587>0.25$. □

Theorem 7.1 improves the pair $(8,5)$ of Part I, Theorem 1.1, to $(7,5)$ from the same analytic input, the level $1/2$. Its only non-rigorous ingredient is the numerical evaluation of f_2 and F_2 in (17): the constants α_2,β_2 are known rigorously [2], the differential-delay system (13) with these initial data is well posed, and our solution of it is checked by the $\kappa=1$ case, by the agreement with [2] and by grid refinement, but we have not carried out the interval-arithmetic certification that Part I, Appendix A, provides for the linear sieve functions; the margins in (17) are three to four orders of magnitude above the observed discretisation error.

7.3. **Comparison with the vector sieve.** Table 4 compares, at the three levels of distribution that occur in these papers, the smallest attainable values of $1/\lambda+2/b$ and $1/\lambda+1/b$ for the two sieves (floating point; the vector sieve values are those of Figure 2), and the largest margin $L_2-\lambda R_2$ for the pairs of interest. At the level $1/2$ the vector sieve attains 8.03 and 5.44, just missing $(7,\cdot)$, while the two-dimensional sieve attains 7.56 and 5.07: $(7,5)$ is obtained with margin 0.13, and $(7,4)$ is missed by 0.03. At $2/3$ (the level that Proposition 4.2 would give for every N from a saving $(mm')^{-1/4}$) both sieves give $(6,4)$, the two-dimensional one with margin 0.196 against 0.037; at $19/20$ the two-dimensional sieve gives $(5,3)$ with margin 0.24, where the vector sieve reached $(5,3)$ only at the edge of its parameter range (Section 3).

θ	vector sieve		dimension 2		margin $L_2-\lambda R_2$ for the pair, at (a,b,λ)	
	$1/\lambda+2/b$	$1/\lambda+1/b$	$1/\lambda+2/b$	$1/\lambda+1/b$		
$1/2$	8.03	5.44	7.56	5.07	$(7,5)$: $+0.132$ $(0.054,\ 0.42,\ 0.309)$	$(7,4)$: -0.030
$2/3$	6.79	4.64	6.37	4.50	$(6,4)$: $+0.196$ $(0.076,\ 0.50,\ 1/3)$	$(5,4)$: -0.157
$19/20$	5.60	3.83	5.21	3.75	$(5,3)$: $+0.238$ $(0.124,\ 0.50,\ 1/2)$	$(4,3)$: -0.099

TABLE 4. The two sieves for $n(N-n)$ (`results/dhr_sieve.txt`, `results/sieve_thresholds.txt`): the bound $\Omega(n(N-n))\le k$, resp. $\max\Omega\le k'$, requires $1/\lambda+2/b\le k+1$, resp. $1/\lambda+1/b\le k'+1$, with $L-\lambda R>0$. The vector sieve values at $2/3$ are those of Figure 2 at $\theta=0.67$. Floating point.

8. Beyond the level 1/2: the sum over the moduli

We end with the question that the sieve route leaves open for every N: the level of distribution beyond $1/2$. At the level θ, the remainder of the sieve (the vector sieve of Part I as well as the two-dimensional sieve of Section 7) is a sum

$$\sum_{\substack{de\le N^\theta\\ (d,e)=1,\ (de,2N)=1}} \lambda_d\lambda'_e\, R(d,e;N) \tag{18}$$

with sieve weights $|\lambda_d|,|\lambda'_e|\le 1$ supported on square-free integers, and by (4) each $R(d,e;N)$ is a bounded combination of coefficients $a_{G_{d',e'}}(N')$ with $d'e'\asymp de$ (up to divisors of N) and $N'\in\{N,N/2\}$. Part I bounds (18) by $\sum|R(d,e;N)|$ and each term by $N^{1/2+\varepsilon}$ (Theorem 1.1(ii)), which gives $N^{1/2+\varepsilon}N^\theta$ and hence $\theta<1/2$; Proposition 4.2 shows that any power saving $(de)^{-\eta}$ in the individual bound raises the level. The other possibility is cancellation between the terms: $R(d,e;N)$ changes sign with (d,e), and the sieve weights are sign-changing too.

8.1. **The structure of the sum.** Since $\sum_{d|n,\ e|N-n} r(n)r(N-n)=T(d,e;N)$ for coprime d,e, the sum (18) is, before the Möbius inversion of $(n,N)=1$,

$$\sum_{d,e}\lambda_d\lambda'_e\big(T(d,e;N)-M(d,e;N)\big)=\sum_{d,e}\lambda_d\lambda'_e\Big(\sum_{d\alpha+e\beta=N} r(\alpha)r(\beta)-M(d,e;N)\Big),$$

a weighted count of the representations of N by the family of quaternary forms $Q_{d,e}$. Writing $n=d\alpha$ and $N-n=e\beta$, the main sum is

$$\sum_e \lambda'_e \sum_{\substack{d,\alpha\\ d\alpha\equiv N\ (e)}} \lambda_d\, r(\alpha)\, r\Big(\frac{N-d\alpha}{e}\Big), \tag{19}$$

the distribution of the products $d\alpha$, weighted by $\lambda_d r(\alpha)$, in the residue class N modulo e, with the additional weight $r((N-d\alpha)/e)$ attached to the quotient. Without the last factor this is the setting of the dispersion method of Bombieri, Friedlander and Iwaniec [3]: sums $\sum_q\lambda_q\sum_{mn\equiv a\ (q)}\alpha_m\beta_n$ with well-factorable λ, for which the level $4/7$ is known for suitable α,β from the Deshouillers–Iwaniec bounds for sums of Kloosterman sums. The factor $r((N-d\alpha)/e)=4\sum_{k|(N-d\alpha)/e}\chi(k)$ introduces a third modulus: (19) becomes $4\sum_{e,k}\lambda'_e\chi(k)\sum_{d\alpha\equiv N\ (ek)}\lambda_d r(\alpha)$, the distribution of $d\alpha$ in progressions to the moduli ek, where k runs up to $N/(de)$, so that the moduli ek range up to N. This is the shape of the Titchmarsh divisor problem, $\sum_q\sum_{mn\equiv a\ (q)}$ over all $q\le x$, which the dispersion method does handle (Fouvry, Bombieri–Friedlander–Iwaniec), with the difference that here both $d\alpha$ and the quotient carry the arithmetic weight r and the modulus e carries a sieve weight. We expect that the dispersion method, applied to (19) with the moduli e in a range N^{θ_e} and the bilinear structure of $\lambda_d r(\alpha)$, gives a level $\theta>1/2$ for the signed sum (18) and

with it an improvement of Theorem 7.1 for every N; we have not carried this out. The spectral version of the same question is the sum over the levels $4de$ of the inner products $\langle G_{d,e}, P_N^{(4de)}\rangle$ of Section 4.

8.2. **The signs of $a_{G_{d,e}}(N)$, numerically.** Whether cancellation of this kind is present can be measured. The script `modulus_sum_scan.py` computes, for a fixed $N \equiv 2 \pmod 4$ and all coprime odd square-free pairs (d,e) with $de \le N^{3/4}$, the coefficients $a_{d,e} = a_{G_{d,e}}(N) = T(d,e;N) - M(d,e;N)$ exactly (the main term for every N by the formulae of Section 6.4), and compares the sums

$$A = \sum |a_{d,e}|, \qquad Q = \Big(\sum a_{d,e}^2\Big)^{1/2},$$
$$S_1 = \sum a_{d,e}, \qquad S_\mu = \sum \mu(de)\, a_{d,e}, \qquad S_{\mathrm{rnd}} = \sum \pm a_{d,e}$$

(all sums over the pairs with $de \le N^\theta$), where $\pm$ are independent random signs; $|S|/Q \approx 1$ is square-root cancellation and A/Q is the maximum. Table 5 shows the result.

N	θ	pairs	A/N	Q/N	S_1/Q	S_μ/Q	S_{rnd}/Q	A/Q
$2000002 = 2\cdot 101\cdot 9901$	0.50	2149	0.82	0.024	−0.43	0.66	1.93	35
	0.60	10367	2.43	0.033	−0.75	0.55	−0.05	73
	0.70	49699	6.78	0.044	1.43	−0.76	0.39	154
	0.75	108127	10.93	0.049	2.01	−1.30	0.69	221
$2000006 = 2\cdot 1000003$	0.50	2149	0.85	0.025	2.15	0.38	0.29	35
	0.60	10367	2.49	0.034	2.34	−0.11	1.50	74
	0.70	49699	6.83	0.044	0.40	−0.20	1.82	154
	0.75	108131	11.01	0.050	1.74	−0.75	2.88	221
$2000018 = 2\cdot 293\cdot 3413$	0.50	2149	0.86	0.025	−1.87	−1.34	0.63	34
	0.60	10367	2.49	0.034	−1.78	−0.54	1.09	73
	0.70	49699	6.77	0.045	−1.13	1.04	−0.08	152
	0.75	108131	10.90	0.050	0.71	1.29	0.89	218
$3000002 = 2\cdot 557\cdot 2693$	0.50	2677	0.78	0.021	0.51	0.37	1.08	38
	0.60	13515	2.35	0.029	1.05	−0.25	0.72	82
	0.70	67357	6.63	0.038	2.18	−0.97	1.52	177
	0.75	149721	10.81	0.042	3.28	−0.06	1.08	257

TABLE 5. Sums of $a_{G_{d,e}}(N)$ over the coprime odd square-free pairs with $de \le N^\theta$ (`results/modulus_sum_scan.txt`). Floating point.

For all three weightings the sums are of the size Q, the square root of the sum of squares, as for independent random signs ($|S_\mu|/Q \le 1.3$, $|S_{\mathrm{rnd}}|/Q \le 2.9$, $|S_1|/Q \le 3.3$ in the table): the coefficients $a_{G_{d,e}}(N)$ for different (d,e) show no sign correlation with each other or with $\mu(de)$, and the signed sums are smaller than $\sum|a_{d,e}|$ by the factor A/Q, which grows with θ (from 35 at $\theta = 1/2$ to 220 at 3/4). The sum A itself is already larger than N for $\theta \ge 0.55$ at these N, which is why the proofs need N large; the signed sums are 0.02–0.05 N. Since $|a_{d,e}| \approx N^{1/2}(de)^{-1/2}\log(de)$ on average (Theorem 1.2 and Section 5), $Q \approx N^{1/2}(\log N)^{3/2}$ for every θ, while $A \approx N^{1/2+\theta/2}$; both are $o(N)$ for $\theta < 1$ if Conjecture 4.1 holds, but only the cancellation visible here is available without it. The data are, of course, no substitute for a proof: they say that the sum (18) behaves as the dispersion method would predict, not how to prove it.

DATA AND CODE

The scripts `mean_square_check.py`, `norm_level20.py`, `certify_modular.py` (arguments `1/2`, `2/3`, `19/20`), `plot_mean_square.py` and `plot_sieve_thresholds.py`

(Figures 1 and 2), `local_densities.py` and `cusp_lower_bound.py` (Table 3), `dhr_sieve.py` (Section 7, output `results/dhr_sieve.txt`), `modulus_sum_scan.py` (Table 5, output `results/modulus_sum_scan.txt`), the modules of Part I they use (`sup_error_scan.py`, `modular_sieve_scan.py`, `sieve_core.py`) and the outputs `results/mean_square_check_x21.txt`, `results/norm_level20.txt`, `results/certify_modular_output_twothirds.txt`, `results/certify_modular_output_nineteen.txt`, `results/sieve_thresholds.txt`, `results/cusp_lower_bound.txt`, `results/cusp_lower_bound_large.txt` are in the repository https://github.com/Ruqing1963/two-squares-mean-square; the code and data of Part I are at https://github.com/Ruqing1963/two-squares-theta-level. The certification of the sieve parameters uses directed rounding as described in Part I, Appendix A; the computations of Section 5 are in floating point and are evidence, not proof.

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